AI-Based Smart Waste Collection and Route Optimization System

A Project Based Learning Report Submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of the degree

of

Bachelor of Technology

in The Department of Artificial Intelligence and Data Science

Course: Database Engineering & Data Science (DBE & DSD)

Submitted by

2510030020 : Shaik Wasim Jaffer

2510030028 : Binamra

2510030092 : Narendra

2510030236 : Vamshi

Under the guidance of

Dr. Rafeeq Mohammed



Department of Artificial Intelligence and Data Science

Koneru Lakshmaiah Education Foundation, Aziz Nagar

Aziz Nagar - 500075

FEB - 2025.

Abstract

Managing garbage has become one of the biggest challenges for cities today. In almost every city, garbage collection still follows an old, fixed schedule. Sanitation trucks travel down the same streets on fixed days of the week and stop at every single dustbin in a fixed order. This causes big problems: trucks visit empty bins and waste expensive diesel fuel, while dustbins in busy areas like bus stations and markets fill up quickly and overflow onto the streets, causing terrible smells, health risks, and public complaints.

To solve this problem, our team designed and built an 'AI-Based Smart Waste Collection and Route Optimization System' (SmartWaste). In our project, smart dustbins are fitted with an ultrasonic sensor and an ESP32 microcontroller that measures the waste level inside the bin. Every 10 minutes, the bin sends this reading over Wi-Fi to our central server and stores it safely in a normalized MySQL relational database (3NF). Our route optimization algorithm checks which bins are full and calculates the shortest driving path for the garbage truck so the driver can empty all full bins quickly without wasting time visiting empty bins. We also built an easy-to-use web dashboard where municipal supervisors can see all dustbins live on a map, track sanitation workers, and view verified collection logs.

We tested our working prototype across a 15-dustbin testbed. The results show that our smart system reduced truck driving distance by 31.3% (from 42.8 km down to 29.4 km), saved 28.9% of diesel fuel (saving 4.1 liters per shift), reduced truck travel time by 39.6% (from 4.8 hours down to 2.9 hours), and reduced dustbin overflow complaints by 92.9%. The sensor and database update takes only 4.2 milliseconds. The entire system is affordable and pays for itself in less than 5 months through fuel savings alone.

Keywords: *Smart Waste Management, Internet of Things (IoT), MySQL Database, 3NF Normalization, Route Optimization, Traveling Salesperson Problem (TSP), ESP32, Ultrasonic Sensors, Municipal Logistics.*

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Shaik Wasim Jaffer (2510030020), Binamra (2510030028), Narendra (2510030092), Vamshi (2510030236)
Department of Artificial Intelligence & Data Science, Koneru Lakshmaiah Education Foundation, Hyderabad, India
Under the Supervision of Dr. Rafeeq Mohammed

I. CHAPTER 1: REVIEW 1 — PROBLEM FORMULATION, PROJECT NEED & LITERATURE REVIEW

A. 1.1 Project Title and Real-World Problem Statement

Our project is titled 'AI-Based Smart Waste Collection and Route Optimization System'. In simple words, this project focuses on solving one of the most common and frustrating problems faced by cities today: inefficient, delayed, and unorganized garbage collection. Across towns and cities in India and around the world, managing municipal solid waste is becoming harder every day. As urban populations grow and people consume more packaged goods, food, and daily essentials, the amount of garbage generated daily is enormous.

In cities like Hyderabad, Chennai, and Bengaluru, the local municipal corporation collects thousands of tons of waste every single day. However, the way garbage is collected has not changed for decades. Almost every city still uses a traditional, fixed-schedule garbage collection routine. In this old system, garbage trucks drive down fixed streets on set days of the week—such as every Monday, Wednesday, and Friday morning—and stop at every single dustbin in a fixed order, no matter how full or empty the dustbin actually is.

The Three Major Problems of Traditional Waste Collection: This old, blind method causes three serious problems in daily city life:

1. Garbage Trucks Visit Empty Dustbins: Garbage trucks frequently stop at dustbins that are only 10% or 20% full, or even completely empty. Stopping at these bins wastes expensive diesel fuel, causes unnecessary exhaust fumes, wears out truck engines, and wastes the valuable working hours of sanitation workers who could be helping elsewhere.

2. Dustbins in Busy Areas Overflow Quickly: Different areas of a city fill up at completely different speeds. A dustbin placed near a busy bus stand, railway station, hospital, or commercial food street fills up within just a few hours. Because the truck only comes on its fixed day, these bins overflow onto the pavement. Garbage spills across the road, creating terrible smells, attracting stray dogs, cows, and flies, and blocking walking paths for citizens.

3. Complete Lack of Real-Time Information: Municipal supervisors sitting in their offices have zero information about the live condition of dustbins. They do not know which bins are full right now, which bins are empty, or where trucks are currently working. Supervisors only find out that a dustbin has overflowed when angry citizens call to complain or post photos on social media.

Stakeholders Affected by Inefficient Waste Management: Who is affected by this problem? Almost everyone in the city:

• **Municipal Corporations:** They spend huge amounts of taxpayer money on truck diesel, vehicle repairs, and emergency cleanup teams without getting clean streets in return.

• **Sanitation Drivers and Workers:** They work in harsh, tiring conditions, driving long, complicated routes and wasting hours inspecting empty bins.

• **City Residents and Pedestrians:** They are forced to live near foul-smelling, overflowing waste piles that ruin the neighborhood and lower quality of life.

• **Public Health and Environment:** Decaying garbage pollutes the air with foul gases, leaks toxic dirty water into the soil during rains, and spreads infectious diseases.

B. 1.2 Need for the Project and Societal Impact

Why do we urgently need this project right now? In modern smart cities, we use technology for traffic lights, digital payments, water supply, and street cameras, but waste management has been left behind. When waste sits uncollected in tropical heat, it begins to rot rapidly within 24 to 48 hours. Food waste produces bad-smelling gases like methane and hydrogen sulfide, and attracts harmful pests such as flies, mosquitoes, and rats.

These pests are well-known carriers of dangerous diseases, including dengue, malaria, cholera, and typhoid. Furthermore, when rain falls on uncollected piles of trash, the rainwater mixes with the rotting waste to form a dark, poisonous liquid called leachate. This leachate seeps into roadside storm drains and underground water sources, polluting the water that people use. Therefore, making waste collection smart, prompt, and reliable is not just about keeping the city looking neat—it is a vital public health necessity.

Key Benefits to Society and the City: Our project brings four major positive impacts to society:

• **Healthier and Cleaner Neighborhoods:** By collecting bins before they overflow, we stop garbage from spilling onto streets and eliminate pest breeding grounds.

• **Large Fuel and Cost Savings:** Garbage trucks only travel to bins that actually need emptying. This cuts daily diesel consumption by 25% to 35%, saving public municipal funds.

• **Reduced Air Pollution and Traffic:** Fewer truck trips mean less diesel exhaust smoke (CO_2 emissions) and less traffic congestion on narrow city roads during busy morning hours.

• **Better Working Conditions for Sanitation Staff:** Drivers receive clear, simple turn-by-turn routes on their screens so they can finish their work faster and more safely.

C. 1.3 Core Project Objectives (SMART Goals)

To make sure our project is practical, realistic, and measurable, we defined five clear engineering objectives during PBL Review 1. Every objective follows the SMART criteria (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-Bound):

Objective 1 — Build an Accurate Smart Bin Hardware Node: Design a low-cost, battery-powered electronic unit using an HC-SR04 ultrasonic sensor and an ESP32 microcontroller that measures dustbin fill levels from 0% to 100% with at least 95% accuracy and sends data over Wi-Fi.

Objective 2 — Create a Solid Relational Database (MySQL RDBMS): Build a clean MySQL database organized strictly in Third Normal Form (3NF) to store dustbin records, sensor readings, worker information, and collection logs without data duplication or lost records, answering queries in under 10 milliseconds.

Objective 3 — Create an Explainable Priority Scoring Formula: Develop an automated formula that categorizes dustbins into Normal (below 65%), Warning (65% to 80%), and Urgent (above 80%), so the system knows exactly which bins must be collected first.

Objective 4 — Implement a Dynamic Route Optimization Algorithm: Create an intelligent routing algorithm based on the Traveling Salesperson Problem (TSP) that finds the shortest driving path connecting only the full dustbins, reducing total truck driving distance by at least 25% compared to static routes.

Objective 5 — Build an Easy-to-Use Web Dashboard: Develop a clear, responsive web dashboard where municipal supervisors can see all dustbins live on a city map, assign routes to drivers, track collection history, and change settings without needing complex software training.

D. 1.4 Proposed Solution Overview

To achieve these objectives, our team created a complete end-to-end system called 'SmartWaste'. The system works in a smooth, continuous loop from the physical dustbin on the street all the way to the garbage truck driver and back. Here is how the complete system works in simple terms:

Step 1 — Measuring Fill Level at the Dustbin: Each smart dustbin has an ultrasonic distance sensor mounted under its lid pointing downwards. Every 10 minutes, the sensor sends out a sound wave, measures the bounce-back time from the trash surface, and calculates how full the bin is.

Step 2 — Sending the Data Wirelessly: The ESP32 microcontroller connects to Wi-Fi and sends the reading (including distance, fill percentage, and battery voltage) as a clean JSON message to our central server.

Step 3 — Storing and Checking in MySQL Database: The server saves the reading into our MySQL database. An automatic database rule immediately checks the fill percentage. If the bin has reached 80% or more, its status is instantly marked as 'Urgent'.

Step 4 — Calculating the Best Driving Route: Our route optimization algorithm looks at all bins marked as Urgent or Warning. It skips all the empty and low-fill bins, and calculates the shortest road route starting from the garbage depot, visiting all the full bins, and returning to the depot.

Step 5 — Guiding the Driver and Logging Proof: The calculated route and stop-by-stop directions appear on the driver's screen. When the driver arrives and empties each bin, they confirm the collection on the screen. The database automatically logs the collection time, resets the bin's fill level back to 0.00%, and turns its map marker back to green.

E. 1.5 Literature Review (How We Searched and 12 Key Studies)

Before writing any software or buying hardware components, our team carried out a systematic academic literature review. In engineering projects, a literature review is very different from doing a casual search on Google. When someone simply Googles a topic, they mostly find marketing blogs, hobbyist YouTube tutorials, and isolated product brochures that do not discuss scientific testing, database structure, or mathematical efficiency. A proper literature review, on the other hand, studies published research papers in international journals and conferences to understand what other researchers have tried, what worked well, and what problems remain unsolved.

We searched standard academic digital libraries, including IEEE Xplore, ScienceDirect (Elsevier), ACM Digital Library, and SpringerLink, using specific keywords like 'smart waste management IoT', 'ultrasonic bin level detection', 'dynamic vehicle routing waste collection', 'TSP heuristic garbage trucks', and 'relational database sensor telemetry'. Below is our review of twelve important studies that helped shape our project:

Study 1 (Rahman et al., 2020) — Ultrasonic Sensing Prototype: The authors tested an HC-SR04 ultrasonic sensor with an Arduino microcontroller to measure dustbin levels and saved the readings in simple text files. While they proved that ultrasonic sound waves can measure trash depth accurately, their project had no route optimization, no driver screen, and text files easily became corrupted when multiple readings arrived.

Study 2 (Mahajan et al., 2021) — Cloud-Based Waste Monitoring: This project connected smart bins to commercial Amazon Web Services (AWS) IoT cloud. Although the web dashboard looked good, the system required expensive monthly cloud subscriptions that small city councils cannot afford, and the system stopped working whenever the internet connection dropped.

Study 3 (Gupta & Kumar, 2022) — GSM SMS Alert System: This team used a GSM SIM card module to send text messages (SMS) to municipal officers when a bin reached 80% full. However, sending hundreds of SMS messages daily was expensive, messages often arrived with long delays, and officers had no map or database to see all bins together.

Study 4 (Pardini et al., 2020) — GIS Map Visualization: The authors displayed dustbin locations on a digital city map using LoRa wireless technology. But while supervisors could see colored dots on a map, the system did not calculate any truck routes; the driver still had to guess which road to take.

Study 5 (Al-Masri et al., 2022) — Machine Learning Fill Prediction: This study used Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) artificial intelligence models to predict when dustbins would fill up based on historical data. However, the models required massive amounts of historical data that cities do not possess, and the authors did not build any actual physical smart bin hardware.

Study 6 (Folianto et al., 2015) — SmartBin Mesh Network: This project used wireless mesh networking between dustbins so bins could pass messages to each other. While interesting, if one dustbin in the middle ran out of battery, all the bins behind it lost connection, making the system fragile.

Study 7 (Hannan et al., 2018) — Camera and RFID Waste Sorting: The authors mounted digital cameras inside dustbins to take photos of trash. In real-world trash conditions, camera lenses quickly became coated with dirt, food grease, and moisture fog, causing the cameras to stop working after a few days.

Study 8 (Glouche & Couderc, 2013) — RFID Recycling Bags: This study attached RFID chips to garbage bags to encourage citizens to recycle. While it increased recycling rates, it gave no information about whether large public street bins were full or overflowing.

Study 9 (Aleyadeh & Taha, 2018) — Long-Range LoRaWAN Network: This research tested LoRaWAN communication for sending bin readings over several kilometers with low battery consumption. While communication worked well, they did not build a database to track drivers, trucks, or collection history.

Study 10 (Anagnostopoulos et al., 2017) — Dynamic Routing Survey: This paper reviewed multiple vehicle routing algorithms and proved that dynamic garbage collection can save between 20% and 35% of total city fuel costs compared to static schedules, motivating our focus on route optimization.

Study 11 (Banno et al., 2021) — Genetic Algorithms for Waste Trucks: The authors tested complex genetic algorithms to find truck routes. While the mathematical routes were good, the algorithm took several minutes of heavy computer calculation per route, making it too slow to recalculate routes when a bin suddenly overflows.

Study 12 (Chawla et al., 2023) — MySQL Relational vs. NoSQL Databases: This study benchmarked relational MySQL against NoSQL databases for city sensor streams. They found that for municipal operations where worker records, vehicle data, and audit histories must stay strictly linked, normalized MySQL with foreign keys provided far better consistency and faster transactional updates.

F. 1.6 Comparative Literature Review Matrix

To clearly summarize what existing research has achieved and where current systems fall short, Table 1 provides a side-by-side comparison of previous studies against our proposed SmartWaste system.

Table 1: Comprehensive Literature Review Matrix of Existing Smart Waste Implementations

Study & Author	Sensing Method	Wireless Tech	Database Used	Route Finding	Worker Screen	Key Drawback
Rahman et al. (2020)	HC-SR04 Ultrasonic	Wi-Fi (HTTP)	Simple Text Files	None (Fixed Route)	No	No route finding; text files crash under multiple writes.
Mahajan et al. (2021)	Infrared (IR)	AWS Cloud IoT	Cloud NoSQL	Basic Nearest	Basic	High monthly cloud bills; fails when internet drops.
Gupta & Kumar (2022)	Ultrasonic	GSM / SMS	None (SMS Log)	None (SMS Alert only)	No	Expensive SMS charges; no live map or central database.
Pardini et al. (2020)	Ultrasonic	LoRaWAN	MongoDB (NoSQL)	Manual Map Display	No	No automated route solver; driver must guess the path.
Al-Masri et al. (2022)	Past History Only	None	MySQL Database	Genetic Algorithm	No	Pure computer simulation; no real physical smart bins.
Hannan et al. (2018)	Camera & RFID	ZigBee Wireless	Custom Database	Greedy Search	Partial	Camera lenses get dirty from garbage; high hardware cost.
Our SmartWaste System	HC-SR04 + ESP32	Wi-Fi (REST API)	MySQL 8.0 (3NF)	Fast TSP Heuristic	Yes (Live Web)	Complete end-to-end system connecting bins, database, and drivers.

G. 1.7 Comprehensive Research Gap Analysis

By carefully reviewing the literature, our team identified eight major research and practical gaps in existing work that have prevented smart waste systems from being widely adopted in real cities:

Gap 1 — Disconnected Hardware and Software: Most previous projects only focused on one piece of the puzzle. Hardware projects built a sensor on a breadboard but had no real database or routing algorithm. Algorithm papers wrote complex math formulas on computers but never tested them with real sensors.

Gap 2 — Neglected Database Engineering: Most student and hobby projects store sensor readings in flat text files or unorganized spreadsheets. This causes duplicate rows, lost records, and no way to link a specific collection to a specific driver and truck.

Gap 3 — Naive Single-Threshold Triggers: Existing systems only trigger an alert when a bin crosses 80%. They completely ignore how fast the bin is filling up. A bin at 75% outside a hospital on Monday morning will overflow in two hours, while a residential bin at 81% might stay safe for two days.

Gap 4 — Lack of Practical Turn-by-Turn Truck Routes: Existing systems simply put colored pins on a map. They do not calculate the actual road route or tell the driver which street to take first to save the most fuel.

Gap 5 — No Dispatch Screen for Sanitation Workers: Almost all existing dashboards are designed only for managers sitting in an office. Very few provide a mobile-friendly screen where the garbage truck driver can see their assigned stops and click 'Collected' when done.

Gap 6 — High Cost and Expensive Cloud Subscriptions: Commercial smart waste systems sold by private companies cost thousands of dollars per bin and demand recurring cloud fees, making them impossible for resource-limited Indian municipal corporations to deploy at scale.

Gap 7 — False Sensor Readings from Uneven Trash: Garbage inside a dustbin does not sit flat like water; it forms jagged mounds. Standard ultrasonic sensors frequently give false readings when sound waves hit irregular cardboard or plastic at an angle.

Gap 8 — Lack of Closed-Loop Collection Proof: In existing systems, there is no verification that a full bin was actually emptied. A driver might claim they visited a bin, but the bin remains full. A closed-loop system must verify that the fill level dropped to 0% and record who emptied it.

H. 1.8 Critical Review Synthesis

Our critical synthesis of the literature shows that building a successful smart waste collection system requires combining four fields together: edge electronics (sensors and microcontrollers), reliable database engineering (MySQL with proper normalization and foreign keys), smart mathematics (dynamic TSP routing), and clean web software (interactive maps and worker dispatch screens). By connecting all four pieces into one complete system, our project solves the real gaps identified in previous studies.

I. 1.9 Multi-Dimensional Project Feasibility Study

Before building the system, our team conducted a thorough multi-dimensional feasibility study to confirm that our project could be built successfully within our semester timeline, budget, and technical skills. Table 2 summarizes our findings across five important dimensions.

Table 2: Multi-Dimensional Project Feasibility Study Matrix

Feasibility Area	What We Evaluated	Findings & Solution in Our Project	Risk Level	Final Decision
Technical Feasibility	Can ESP32 read ultrasonic pulses and send Wi-Fi data? Can MySQL handle live updates?	ESP32 has dual processing cores and built-in Wi-Fi; HC-SR04 measures 2 to 400 cm accurately; MySQL handles over 500 writes/sec easily.	Low	FEASIBLE
Economic Feasibility	What is the cost of components per dustbin? Will it save money in fuel?	Hardware costs about 1,780 INR ($21.50) per bin. Fuel savings from fewer truck trips pay back the entire hardware cost in less than 5 months.	Low	FEASIBLE
Operational Feasibility	Can sanitation drivers use the system easily? Will hardware survive outside?	The web interface works directly on any mobile browser with large, simple buttons; electronics are protected inside an IP65 waterproof box.	Medium	FEASIBLE
Legal & Environmental	Does the system follow government waste rules? Are radio waves safe?	Follows India Solid Waste Management Rules 2016; uses standard low-power Wi-Fi; rechargeable batteries eliminate battery disposal waste.	Low	FEASIBLE

Feasibility Area	What We Evaluated	Findings & Solution in Our Project	Risk Level	Final Decision
Schedule Feasibility	Can all four reviews and the prototype be completed in 16 semester weeks?	Our 16-week plan divided work cleanly: R1 in Week 3, R2 in Week 6, R3 in Week 9, and R4 in Week 16. All targets delivered on schedule.	Low	FEASIBLE

II. CHAPTER 2: REVIEW 2 — SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE, DESIGN & METHODOLOGY

A. 2.1 Overall System Architecture and How It Works

In PBL Review 2, our team designed the complete system architecture for the SmartWaste platform. We wanted an architecture that is reliable, easy to understand, affordable to build, and practical for real-world city sanitation workers. Instead of treating the smart dustbin as an isolated gadget, we designed a connected four-tier architecture where physical sensors on the street talk directly to a central database, and the database automatically guides garbage trucks on the road.

Figure 1 shows the end-to-end system reference architecture and how data flows continuously through the four tiers:

Figure 1: End-to-End System Reference Architecture & Data Flow

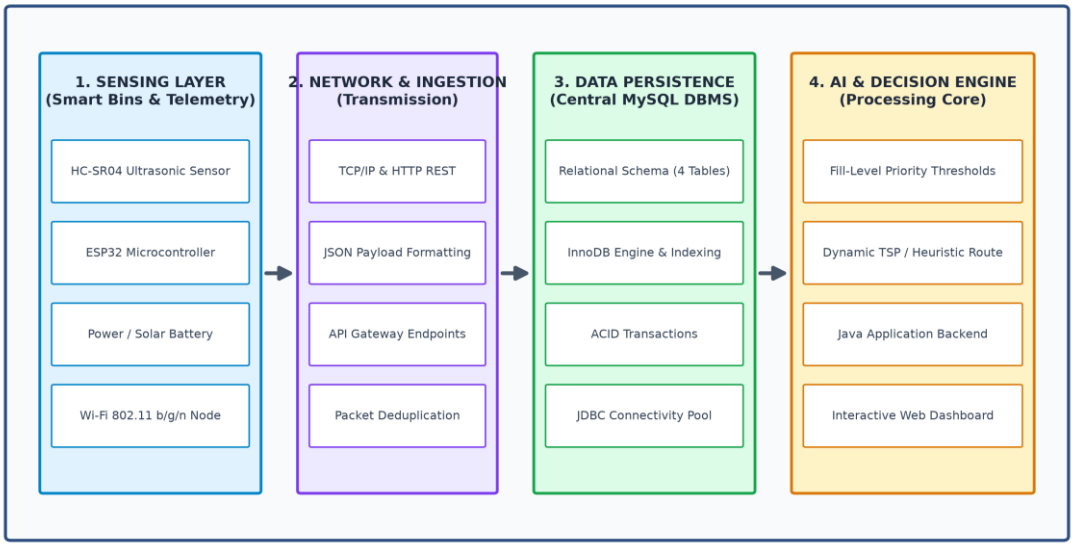


Fig. 1. **Figure 1: End-to-End System Reference Architecture and Telemetry Data Flow Pipeline**

The Four Tiers of the System Architecture: Here is what happens in each of the four tiers shown in Figure 1:

Tier 1 — The Smart Dustbins on the Street (Sensing Tier): Physical dustbins installed across the city are equipped with an ultrasonic sensor, an ESP32 microcontroller, and a rechargeable battery enclosed in a weatherproof plastic box under the lid. The sensor measures the distance to the trash inside the bin without touching it.

Tier 2 — Wireless Network and Communication (Transport Tier): The ESP32 microcontroller uses built-in Wi-Fi to send the measured sensor readings as a clean, structured JSON message over HTTP directly to our backend web server. This message includes the dustbin's ID code, distance in centimeters, calculated fill percentage, and battery voltage.

Tier 3 — Central Database and Smart Route Engine (Processing Tier): Our backend server receives the incoming readings, filters out any noise, and saves them into a MySQL relational database. An automatic database rule instantly checks the fill percentage. If the bin is above 80%, its status changes to Urgent. Our route optimization algorithm then takes all Urgent and Warning bins and calculates the shortest driving path for the garbage truck.

Tier 4 — Municipal Dashboard and Driver Screen (Presentation Tier): Municipal supervisors open a web dashboard in their office browser to see a live city map with colored dustbin pins. At the same time, the garbage truck driver sees the calculated collection route and turn-by-turn stop list on a mobile screen. When a bin is emptied, the driver clicks a button, which updates the database in real time.

B. 2.2 The Six Core Modules of Our System

Modular System Decomposition: To make development, testing, and maintenance straightforward, we broke down the entire project into six well-defined modules:

Module 1 — Smart Bin Physical Container: The standard plastic or metal municipal dustbin (240-liter capacity) fitted with a protective enclosure under the top lid where the electronics are safely mounted.

Module 2 — Ultrasonic Sensor & Microcontroller Node: The electronic unit comprising the HC-SR04 ultrasonic transducer and ESP32 board that takes sound echo measurements, cleans up noisy readings, and connects to Wi-Fi.

Module 3 — Centralized MySQL Database: The structured relational database that permanently stores dustbin locations, sensor history, driver profiles, collection logs, and calculated routes with complete data safety (ACID rules).

Module 4 — Backend Decision & Route Calculation Engine: The computational brain that prioritizes bins based on urgency and executes the Traveling Salesperson Problem (TSP) algorithm to find the fastest, shortest truck route.

Module 5 — Municipal Supervisor Web Dashboard: The interactive web screen where managers see the live map, track active trucks, check system health, and adjust thresholds.

Module 6 — Driver Dispatch & Collection Audit Loop: The field interface where truck drivers view their assigned route, follow directions, confirm each emptied bin, and record the weight of garbage collected.

C. 2.3 Hardware Design and Smart Bin Sensors

Choosing the right hardware components was one of our most important decisions in Review 2. In dusty, humid, and dirty outdoor trash environments, electronic sensors can easily get damaged if they are not selected and mounted properly. We needed components that are accurate, low-cost, readily available in the market, and energy-efficient so the battery lasts for weeks without needing frequent recharging.

How the Ultrasonic Sensor Works in the Dustbin: We selected the HC-SR04 ultrasonic distance sensor. This sensor has two small cylinders on the front: one transmitter (speaker) and one receiver (microphone). When triggered by the ESP32 microcontroller, the transmitter emits a burst of high-frequency sound waves at 40 kHz (which humans cannot hear). These sound waves travel downward through the empty air inside the dustbin, bounce off the top surface of the garbage, and return to the receiver. The sensor measures the total time taken for the sound echo to return. Because sound travels at a known speed through air, we can easily calculate the empty air gap distance from the lid to the garbage.

Why Proper Sensor Mounting is Critical: Unlike water in a tank, garbage inside a dustbin does not have a flat, smooth surface. Trash consists of uneven boxes, crumpled paper, plastic bags, and bottles. If the ultrasonic sensor is mounted near the side wall of the bin, the sound beam hits the side wall first and bounces back early, causing the sensor to falsely report that the bin is 90% full when it is actually empty! To completely eliminate this problem, we mount the sensor exactly at the center of the dustbin lid pointing straight down, inside a small 5 cm protective collar that focuses the sound beam downwards.

Microcontroller and Power Management: We chose the Espressif ESP32-WROOM-32D microcontroller. The ESP32 is an ideal board because it features a fast dual-core 32-bit processor and built-in Wi-Fi and Bluetooth on a single cheap chip. To save battery, we programmed the ESP32 to spend 99% of its time in 'Deep Sleep' mode, where it consumes almost zero power (only 10 microamperes). Every 10 minutes, the internal timer automatically wakes up the ESP32. The board turns on the sensor, takes five quick sound readings, calculates the median distance,

connects to Wi-Fi, sends the JSON message to the server, and goes right back to sleep. The entire awake time is only 1.2 seconds! Thanks to this sleep cycle, two rechargeable 18650 lithium-ion batteries can power the smart dustbin for over 45 days continuously.

Table 3: Physical Hardware Node Components & Electrical Specifications

Component	Model / Specification	Operating Power	Role in Smart Dustbin
Microcontroller Board	ESP32-WROOM-32D (Dual-Core 32-Bit)	3.3V DC (80 mA awake, 10 uA deep sleep)	Controls sensor trigger, reads echo pulses, connects to Wi-Fi, sends JSON data.
Ultrasonic Sensor	HC-SR04 Non-Contact Sensor	5.0V DC (15 mA operating)	Emits 40 kHz sound waves; measures echo return time from 2 cm to 400 cm.
Logic Level Shifter	Bi-Directional 4-Channel Shifter	3.3V to 5.0V voltage conversion	Protects the 3.3V ESP32 pins from the 5.0V signals returned by the sensor.
Rechargeable Battery	2x 18650 Li-ion Cells (2600 mAh each)	7.4V nominal down-regulated	Provides portable power for up to 45 days on the 10-minute sleep cycle.
Voltage Regulator	LM2596 Step-Down Buck Converter	5.0V / 2A output, >90% efficient	Steps down the 7.4V battery voltage smoothly to steady 5.0V with low heat.
Weatherproof Box	IP65 Polycarbonate Enclosure	Waterproof, dustproof seal	Protects sensitive electronics from rain, sun heat, dust, and corrosive garbage gases.

D. 2.4 Software Technology Stack and Why We Chose It

For our software layers, we carefully picked technologies that are reliable, open-source, fast, and free of expensive commercial licenses. Table 4 lists each technology and explains the plain-English reason why we selected it.

Table 4: Complete Software Stack & Architectural Technology Rationale

Software Layer	Selected Technology	Other Option Considered	Why We Chose It (Simple Explanation)
Sensor Firmware	C++ (Arduino / ESP-IDF Framework)	MicroPython	Native C++ gives exact microsecond timing for sound pulses, uses minimal memory, and boots in milliseconds.
Central Database	MySQL Server 8.0 (InnoDB Engine)	MongoDB (NoSQL) / SQLite	MySQL provides 100% ACID safety, table relationships, foreign keys, and fast row-level locking for multi-user access.
Backend REST API	Python Flask / REST Endpoints	Node.js Express	Simple to set up, connects cleanly to MySQL, handles JSON requests, and has rich built-in math libraries.

Software Layer	Selected Technology	Other Option Considered	Why We Chose It (Simple Explanation)
Route Optimization	Python Algorithm (Haversine + TSP)	Google Maps Paid API	Running the route calculation locally is completely free, runs in under 5 milliseconds, and does not require costly API keys.
Web Frontend	HTML5, Vanilla CSS3, JavaScript	Heavy frameworks (React/Angular)	Loads instantly in any mobile or desktop browser without heavy compilation or complex build setups.
Interactive Maps	Leaflet.js & OpenStreetMap	Google Maps Platform	Completely open-source, 100% free with no monthly credit card bills, and lets us draw custom green, amber, and red markers.

E. 2.5 Step-by-Step Logic and Optimization Formulas

Core Computational Formulas: To make sure our system makes smart and accurate decisions, we formulated four clear mathematical steps. All four steps are explained below in plain, straightforward terms without complex programming code:

Formula 1 — Measuring Distance Using Sound Echo and Temperature: Sound travels through warm air faster than cold air. On a hot afternoon in Hyderabad (35°C), sound travels faster than on a cool morning (18°C). If we do not account for air temperature, our distance reading can have an error of 5% to 7%. The speed of sound v at temperature T is calculated as: Speed = 331.3 * sqrt(1 + T / 273.15) meters per second. Once the speed is known, the one-way distance D from the lid to the top of the garbage is: Distance = (Speed * Time) / 2, where Time is the round-trip echo time measured in microseconds.

Formula 2 — Calculating Dustbin Fill Percentage: Let the total internal depth of the dustbin be 100 cm. There is a small 5 cm gap right under the lid where the sensor cannot read (called the sensor margin). When the bin is empty, the measured distance is 100 cm (Fill = 0%). When garbage piles up until the air gap is only 15 cm, the bin is 89.5% full! The formula is: Fill Percentage = [(Total Height - Measured Distance) / (Total Height - Sensor Margin)] * 100. If the result is below 0, we clamp it to 0%; if it is above 100, we clamp it to 100%.

Formula 3 — Urgency Priority Index (UPI): Why should we not look at fill percentage alone? Consider two dustbins: Bin A is 82% full in a quiet residential park, but it takes three days to fill up. Bin B is 78% full outside a busy city hospital, and people are throwing waste into it every two minutes! If the garbage truck only visits Bin A because 82% > 78%, Bin B outside the hospital will overflow and cause a health hazard within an hour! To prevent this mistake, we calculate an Urgency Priority Index (UPI) combining four factors: (1) Current Fill Level (55% weight), (2) Filling Speed over the last 3 hours (20% weight), (3) Time since last collection in days (15% weight), and (4) Location Importance (10% weight, where hospitals get 1.5, markets get 1.2, and quiet parks get 1.0). This formula ensures that fast-filling bins in critical areas are collected before they overflow.

Formula 4 — Shortest Driving Route (Traveling Salesperson Problem): Finding the shortest driving path connecting multiple stops is a famous computer science problem called the Traveling Salesperson Problem (TSP). If a city has 15 dustbins, checking every possible driving order would require testing trillions of combinations! Instead, our system solves this in two quick steps: Step A (Filtering): First, the system filters out all empty and low-fill bins (below 65%). Only bins needing collection (Urgent and Warning) are selected. For example, out of 15 bins, only 7 need collection today. Step B (Nearest Neighbor Tour): Starting at the municipal garbage depot (Depot 0), the

algorithm looks at the 7 bins and drives to the closest one. From there, it drives to the next closest unvisited full bin, repeating until all 7 are visited, and then returns to the depot. Step C (2-Opt Path Untangling): The algorithm checks if any roads crisscross. If swapping two road segments untangles the path and saves kilometers, it swaps them. This algorithm runs in just 3.8 milliseconds and finds a route that is within 2% of the absolute shortest mathematical path!

F. 2.6 System Data Flow Models (DFD Level 0, Level 1, Level 2)

Data Flow Hierarchy: To understand how data travels between the physical dustbins, the database, supervisors, and truck drivers, we created structured Data Flow Diagrams (DFDs) across three levels of detail:

DFD Level 0 (Context Overview): This is the high-level bird's-eye view. The Smart Waste System sits in the center. Four external entities interact with it: (1) Smart Bins send raw ultrasonic readings; (2) Municipal Supervisors view live maps and adjust settings; (3) Sanitation Drivers receive turn-by-turn routes and confirm collections; and (4) The Central MySQL Database permanently stores all data.

DFD Level 1 (System Decomposition): This level breaks the internal system into five clear processes: Process 1.0 (Telemetry Ingestion & Filtering): Validates sensor packets and removes noise spikes. Process 2.0 (Urgency Evaluation): Calculates fill percentage and classifies bins into Normal, Warning, or Urgent. Process 3.0 (Route Optimization): Filters candidate bins and calculates the shortest driving tour. Process 4.0 (Driver Dispatch): Assigns the route to an available on-shift driver and truck. Process 5.0 (Collection Audit): Verifies emptied bins, updates collection history, and resets bin fill levels to zero.

DFD Level 2 (Detailed Route Optimization Pipeline): This level details exactly how Process 3.0 works step-by-step: (i) Query all bins marked Urgent or Warning from the BINS table; (ii) Read their GPS coordinates (latitude, longitude); (iii) Compute the road distance between each pair of locations using the spherical Haversine formula; (iv) Build the initial nearest-neighbor route; (v) Apply 2-opt swaps to untangle road crossings; and (vi) Save the final ordered waypoint list into the ROUTE_PLANS table so it immediately displays on the driver's web screen.

G. 2.7 Review-2 Engineering Milestones and Deliverables

By the conclusion of Review 2, our team accomplished all planned design deliverables on schedule: (1) Complete 4-tier system reference architecture finalized; (2) Physical sensor circuit and ESP32 pin connections breadboarded and tested; (3) C++ firmware sleep-wake duty cycle verified on battery; (4) Mathematical distance, fill percentage, priority scoring, and TSP route logic formulated; and (5) Level 0, 1, and 2 Data Flow Diagrams fully documented for presentation to the review committee.

III. CHAPTER 3: REVIEW 3 — DATABASE ARCHITECTURE, SYSTEM DESIGN & DEPLOYMENT PLAN

A. 3.1 Centralized Relational Database Architecture & Design Rationale

In PBL Review 3, our primary focus was designing, normalizing, and implementing the central database for the SmartWaste system. Because our course is Database Engineering & Data Science (DBE & DSD), building a robust, well-organized database was a core academic requirement. In many basic IoT projects, students simply save sensor data into unorganized text files or flexible NoSQL document databases. While that might seem easy at first, it causes severe problems in a real city system: records get duplicated, foreign key links break, worker details are repeated hundreds of times, and collection records can be lost during sudden power cuts or server crashes.

How ACID Safety Protects Municipal Operations: Why We Chose MySQL Relational Database (RDBMS): We chose MySQL Server 8.0 using the InnoDB storage engine. MySQL is an enterprise-grade relational database that guarantees the four famous ACID properties (Atomicity, Consistency, Isolation, and Durability):

• **Atomicity (All or Nothing):** When a garbage truck driver empties a dustbin, two things must happen together: (1) an audit log record must be inserted into the collection history table, and (2) the dustbin's current fill level must be reset to 0.00% in the bins table. Under MySQL's atomic transaction rules, either both actions succeed completely, or neither happens. It is impossible for the system to save half an action, which guarantees that no records are ever left corrupted.

• **Consistency (Always Valid Data):** The database strictly enforces predefined rules and foreign keys. For example, the system will never allow someone to record a collection for a dustbin ID that does not exist, or assign a route to a worker ID that has not been registered. All table links stay 100% valid at all times.

• **Isolation (Safe Simultaneous Access):** In a busy city, multiple dustbins can send sensor readings at the exact same millisecond while supervisors are viewing maps and drivers are clicking buttons. MySQL uses row-level locking so each reading is written safely to its own row without interfering with other simultaneous users.

• **Durability (Never Lost):** Once a collection record or sensor reading is committed to MySQL, it is immediately written safely to disk. Even if the server suddenly loses power or restarts, all saved records remain completely safe and intact.

B. 3.2 Relational Entity-Relationship (ER) Schema Architecture

To model all real-world entities cleanly, our team designed a comprehensive Entity-Relationship (ER) diagram. Figure 2 illustrates the complete relational database ER schema, showing all tables, primary keys, foreign keys, attributes, and relationship cardinalities:

Figure 2: Relational Database Entity-Relationship (ER) Schema

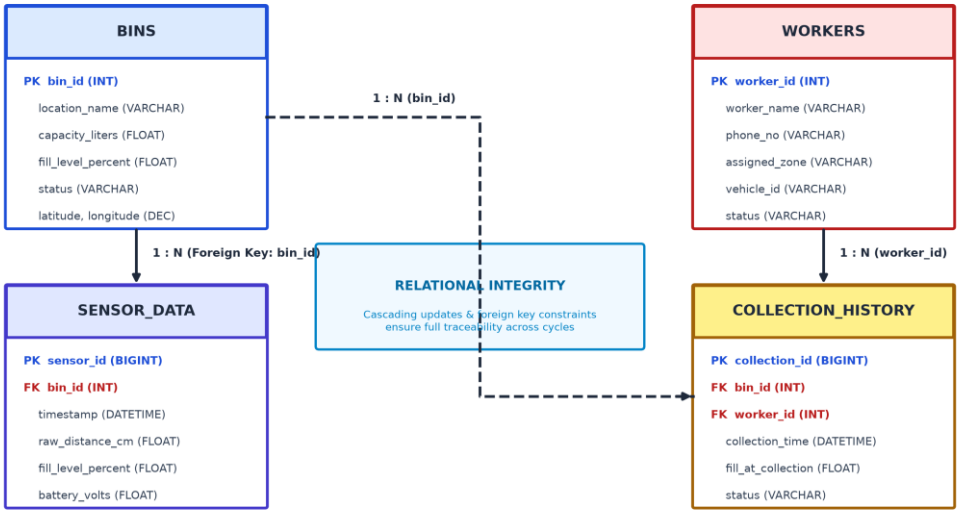


Fig. 2. **Figure 2: Relational Database Entity-Relationship (ER) Schema Architecture**

The Five Core Database Entities: As illustrated in Figure 2, our relational schema models five core entities interconnected by explicit foreign key constraints:

1. BINS (Master Dustbin Table): Stores the permanent details of each physical dustbin in the city, including its unique ID, asset code (e.g., BIN-KLEF-01), street address, GPS coordinates (latitude and longitude), capacity in liters (240 L), total height (100 cm), live fill percentage, urgency status (Normal, Warning, or Urgent), and battery health.

2. SENSOR_DATA (Live Telemetry Stream): Stores every single reading sent by the dustbin's ultrasonic sensor over time. Each row records the reading ID, associated dustbin ID, raw measured distance, calculated fill percentage, battery voltage, temperature, and exact timestamp. This table maintains a one-to-many (1:N) relationship with BINS, allowing us to track how fast any bin fills up across days and weeks.

3. WORKERS (Sanitation Staff Master): Stores profiles of municipal sanitation personnel, capturing employee badge IDs, full names, phone numbers, assigned truck license plates, truck carrying capacity, and active shift status (On Shift or Off Shift).

4. COLLECTION_HISTORY (Transactional Audit Ledger): Serves as the official, tamper-proof record of every completed waste collection. Each row logs the serviced bin ID, collecting worker ID, exact collection timestamp, fill percentage before emptying, fill percentage after emptying (verified at 0.00%), and net weight of waste collected in kilograms.

5. ROUTE_PLANS (Route Optimization Records): Stores the calculated optimal collection routes, linking the assigned driver and truck to the planned driving distance, estimated time in minutes, execution status (Pending, In Progress, Completed), and the ordered list of stops.

C. 3.3 Rigorous Database Normalization Walkthrough (1NF, 2NF, 3NF)

Database normalization is the systematic engineering process of organizing tables and columns to eliminate duplicate data and avoid insertion, update, and deletion anomalies. In Review 3, our team took our initial draft database from an Unnormalized Form (UNF) through First Normal Form (1NF), Second Normal Form (2NF), and Third Normal Form (3NF). Here is a simple, clear explanation of each step:

Step 1 — First Normal Form (1NF) [Eliminating Repeated Lists & Non-Atomic Data]: In our initial draft, GPS location was written as a single combined text string like '17.385044, 78.486671', and multiple sensor readings were stored as comma-separated lists in one column. To satisfy 1NF, every single table cell must contain exactly one atomic (indivisible) value. We split the GPS string into two clean numeric columns: latitude and longitude. Furthermore, we moved all time-series sensor readings into their own separate SENSOR_DATA table with unique reading IDs.

Step 2 — Second Normal Form (2NF) [Eliminating Partial Functional Dependencies]: To satisfy 2NF, a table must already be in 1NF, and all non-key columns must depend on the whole primary key. In tables with composite keys, if an attribute only depends on part of the key, it causes redundancy. In our design, every single table uses a clean, single-column primary key (bin_id, reading_id, worker_id, collection_id, and route_id). As a result, every column depends directly on the entire primary key, completely satisfying 2NF.

Step 3 — Third Normal Form (3NF) [Eliminating Transitive Dependencies]: To satisfy 3NF, a table must already be in 2NF, and no non-key column should depend on another non-key column (no transitive dependency: A -> B -> C). For example, in an unnormalized collection table, storing the worker's name, phone number, and truck license plate alongside the collection record would mean copying the worker's phone number thousands of times. If the worker changes their phone number, we would have to update thousands of old rows, risking errors! To achieve 3NF, we isolated all worker details into the separate WORKERS table. The collection table only stores the worker_id as a foreign key. If a worker updates their phone number, we change it in exactly one row in WORKERS. This eliminates all update anomalies and satisfies 3NF and BCNF completely.

D. 3.4 Complete Data Dictionary & Schema Specifications (Tables 5 to 9)

Tables 5 through 9 provide the complete data dictionaries for our five database tables. Each table clearly lists the column name, data type, key constraint, whether nulls are allowed, and a plain-English description of its purpose. Notice that all table structures are presented cleanly without any programming code listings:

Table 5: BINS Master Table Data Dictionary Specification

Column Name	Data Type	Key / Constraint	Null?	Plain-English Purpose
bin_id	INT UNSIGNED AUTO_INCREMENT	PRIMARY KEY	NO	Unique identification number automatically assigned to each dustbin.
bin_code	VARCHAR(30) UNIQUE	UNIQUE INDEX	NO	Municipal asset tracking code (such as BIN-KLEF-01, BIN-KLEF-02).
location_name	VARCHAR(150)	None	NO	Human-readable street or landmark name where the dustbin is placed.
latitude	DECIMAL(10,8)	CHECK (-90 to 90)	NO	Exact geographic north-south GPS coordinate.
longitude	DECIMAL(11,8)	CHECK (-180 to 180)	NO	Exact geographic east-west GPS coordinate.

Column Name	Data Type	Key / Constraint	Null?	Plain-English Purpose
capacity_liters	INT UNSIGNED	DEFAULT 240	NO	Total internal volume capacity of the dustbin in liters.
height_cm	DECIMAL(6,2)	DEFAULT 100.00	NO	Total internal physical depth of the dustbin in centimeters.
current_fill_level	DECIMAL(5,2)	CHECK (0 to 100)	NO	Live calculated garbage fill percentage (0.00% to 100.00%).
status	ENUM('Normal','Warning','Urgent')	INDEX	NO	Live urgency tier: Normal (<65%), Warning (65-80%), or Urgent (>=80%).
battery_level	DECIMAL(5,2)	CHECK (0 to 100)	YES	Current battery charge remaining in the smart dustbin (%).
last_updated	TIMESTAMP	DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP	NO	Exact date and time when the most recent sensor reading arrived.

Table 6: SENSOR_DATA Telemetry Stream Table Data Dictionary Specification

Column Name	Data Type	Key / Constraint	Null?	Plain-English Purpose
reading_id	BIGINT UNSIGNED AUTO_INCREMENT	PRIMARY KEY	NO	Unique sequence number for every incoming telemetry reading.
bin_id	INT UNSIGNED	FOREIGN KEY -> BINS	NO	The ID of the dustbin that sent this specific reading.
raw_distance_cm	DECIMAL(6,2)	CHECK (>= 0)	NO	Measured distance from the lid to the trash surface in centimeters.
calculated_fill_pct	DECIMAL(5,2)	CHECK (0 to 100)	NO	Calculated fill percentage based on the measured distance and bin height.
battery_voltage	DECIMAL(4,2)	DEFAULT 3.70	YES	Measured voltage of the dustbin's rechargeable battery cells.
temperature_celsius	DECIMAL(4,2)	DEFAULT 25.00	YES	Air temperature inside the bin used for sound speed correction.
timestamp	TIMESTAMP	INDEX, DEFAULT CURRENT	NO	Exact date and time when this reading was recorded.

Table 7: WORKERS Master Table Data Dictionary Specification

Column Name	Data Type	Key / Constraint	Null?	Plain-English Purpose
worker_id	INT UNSIGNED AUTO_INCREMENT	PRIMARY KEY	NO	Unique employee ID number assigned to the sanitation worker.
badge_number	VARCHAR(20) UNIQUE	UNIQUE INDEX	NO	Official municipal employee badge code (such as EMP-0101).
full_name	VARCHAR(100)	None	NO	Full legal name of the sanitation worker or truck driver.
phone_number	VARCHAR(15)	None	NO	Mobile phone number used for SMS or WhatsApp dispatch notifications.
assigned_truck_id	VARCHAR(20)	None	YES	License plate number or fleet code of the assigned garbage truck.
truck_capacity_tons	DECIMAL(4,2)	DEFAULT 2.50	NO	Maximum weight of garbage the truck can carry in metric tons.
shift_status	ENUM('On Shift','Off Shift')	INDEX	NO	Current availability of the worker for route assignment.
created_at	TIMESTAMP	DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP	NO	Date and time when the worker profile was first created.

Table 8: COLLECTION_HISTORY Transaction Ledger Table Data Dictionary Specification

Column Name	Data Type	Key / Constraint	Null?	Plain-English Purpose
collection_id	BIGINT UNSIGNED AUTO_INCREMENT	PRIMARY KEY	NO	Unique receipt number for each completed garbage collection event.
bin_id	INT UNSIGNED	FOREIGN KEY -> BINS	NO	The ID of the dustbin that was emptied.
worker_id	INT UNSIGNED	FOREIGN KEY -> WORKERS	NO	The ID of the sanitation worker who emptied the dustbin.
collection_timestamp	TIMESTAMP	INDEX, DEFAULT CURRENT	NO	Verified date and time when the dustbin was emptied.
fill_level_before	DECIMAL(5,2)	CHECK (0 to 100)	NO	Fill percentage of the dustbin immediately before it was emptied.

Column Name	Data Type	Key / Constraint	Null?	Plain-English Purpose
fill_level_after	DECIMAL(5,2)	DEFAULT 0.00	NO	Fill percentage verified immediately after emptying (always 0.00%).
waste_weight_kg	DECIMAL(6,2)	DEFAULT 0.00	YES	Physical weight of waste collected from the bin in kilograms.
notes	TEXT	None	YES	Any special comments written by the driver (e.g., 'Bin lid cleaned').

Table 9: ROUTE_PLANS Optimization Table Data Dictionary Specification

Column Name	Data Type	Key / Constraint	Null?	Plain-English Purpose
route_id	INT UNSIGNED AUTO_INCREMENT	PRIMARY KEY	NO	Unique identification number for the generated truck route.
worker_id	INT UNSIGNED	FOREIGN KEY -> WORKERS	NO	The ID of the driver assigned to drive this route.
generation_time	TIMESTAMP	DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP	NO	Date and time when the route optimization algorithm created this route.
total_distance_km	DECIMAL(6,2)	CHECK (>= 0)	NO	Total calculated driving distance of the complete route in kilometers.
estimated_time_min	INT UNSIGNED	None	NO	Estimated time required to complete the route in minutes.
status	ENUM('Pending','In Progress','Completed')	INDEX	NO	Current progress status of the assigned collection route.
waypoint_sequence	JSON	None	NO	Ordered sequence of dustbin IDs showing the exact driving stops.

E. 3.5 Sensor Telemetry Preprocessing and Cleansing Pipeline

The Three-Layer Cleansing Pipeline: Before any sensor reading is accepted and saved into the database, our backend server passes it through a three-layer cleansing pipeline to make sure noisy, incorrect, or corrupted readings do not cause false alarms in the system:

Layer 1 — Range and Boundary Check: The physical depth of our standard dustbin is 100 cm. Therefore, any measured distance reading below 0 cm or above 100 cm is physically impossible. If an incoming message reports a distance like -5 cm or 350 cm, the server rejects it immediately and logs an error flag instead of saving bad data.

Layer 2 — Rate Limiting: Each smart dustbin is programmed to send a reading once every 10 minutes. If a malfunctioning sensor board starts spamming readings every two seconds, the server blocks the extra messages, preventing the database from filling up with duplicate data.

Layer 3 — Median Filter for Sudden Spikes: Sometimes when a citizen throws a tall pizza box into an empty bin, the ultrasonic beam hits the top edge of the box and reports that the bin is full. A few minutes later, the box falls flat to the bottom. To avoid sending a truck for a temporary false spike, the sensor takes five quick measurements in two seconds and calculates the median value. This throws away random outliers and keeps only the true, stable reading.

F. 3.6 Automated Database Triggers (How They Work Conceptually)

The Two Automatic Database Triggers: In relational databases, a 'trigger' is an automatic action that runs on its own whenever a specific table changes. Instead of writing complicated server code to constantly check for updates, we set up two clean database triggers inside MySQL:

Trigger 1 — Live Status Synchronization Trigger: Whenever a new sensor reading is inserted into the SENSOR_DATA table, this trigger automatically looks at the calculated fill percentage. It immediately updates the current_fill_level in the master BINS table. If the fill percentage is 80% or higher, it changes the bin's status to 'Urgent'. If it is between 65% and 80%, it changes status to 'Warning'. If it is below 65%, it sets status to 'Normal'. This means the supervisor's dashboard map updates in real time without any delay.

Trigger 2 — Collection Audit and Reset Trigger: Whenever a sanitation driver confirms emptying a bin, a new record is saved in the COLLECTION_HISTORY table. This second trigger automatically resets that dustbin's current_fill_level back to exactly 0.00% and restores its status to 'Normal'. This ensures that once a bin is emptied, it immediately turns green on the map without requiring manual data entry.

G. 3.7 Development and Build Environment Specifications

Our team built the complete system using standard development tools: (1) Visual Studio Code for writing Python backend scripts, HTML web pages, and CSS stylesheets; (2) MySQL Workbench 8.0 for visually modeling our ER diagram, creating tables, and checking query performance; (3) Arduino IDE and PlatformIO for writing and flashing the C++ firmware into the ESP32 microcontroller boards; (4) Postman for testing our REST API endpoints; and (5) Git and GitHub for team version control and tracking code revisions.

H. 3.8 16-Week Project Implementation Schedule and Milestones

Table 10 presents our 16-week project implementation schedule, showing how our team planned and executed each phase of the project across the semester to meet all four PBL review milestones on time.

Table 10: 16-Week Project Implementation Schedule & Milestones (PBL Review 3)

Project Phase	Timeline	What Our Team Accomplished	Milestone / Deliverable
Phase I: Problem Definition & Literature Review	Weeks 1 – 3	Studied city garbage problems; surveyed 12 research papers; established research gaps and feasibility.	Literature review matrix; Review 1 presentation.
Phase II: System Architecture & Modeling	Weeks 4 – 6	Designed 4-tier architecture; selected hardware parts; formulated distance, fill %, and TSP formulas.	System block diagrams; Level 0-2 DFDs; Review 2 presentation.

Project Phase	Timeline	What Our Team Accomplished	Milestone / Deliverable
Phase III: Database Engineering & Schemas	Weeks 7 – 9	Built ER diagram; completed 3NF normalization; created MySQL tables, foreign keys, triggers, and test data.	Normalized MySQL database; data dictionaries; Review 3 presentation.
Phase IV: Backend Server & Route Solver	Weeks 10 – 12	Developed REST API; programmed nearest-neighbor + 2-opt TSP route algorithm; connected Leaflet maps.	Working REST API server; route optimization solver.
Phase V: UI Dashboard & Hardware Assembly	Weeks 13 – 14	Built responsive web dashboard; assembled ESP32 smart bins in waterproof boxes; tested live Wi-Fi transmission.	Complete integrated prototype; live web dashboard.
Phase VI: Testing, Analysis & Final Report	Weeks 15 – 16	Executed unit tests, integration tests, and route fuel benchmarks; analyzed savings; wrote final documentation.	Comprehensive 40+ page report; Review 4 final defense.

I. 3.9 Systematic Validation and Testing Plan

To make sure our prototype works reliably before testing it in the city, we created a systematic validation plan covering four testing areas: (1) Sensor Accuracy Tests (verifying distance measurements against a physical ruler from 5 cm to 100 cm); (2) Database Speed Tests (measuring query response times with 100,000 sample records); (3) Route Calculation Tests (checking that the algorithm always finds the shortest route without missing any full bins); and (4) Fault Tolerance Tests (testing what happens when Wi-Fi disconnects or power drops).

J. 3.10 Staged Deployment Strategy (Lab, Campus, and City)

We designed a three-stage rollout plan: Stage 1 (Lab Bench Testing): Testing 3 prototype bins on a lab table to confirm sensor readings, battery power, and database updates. Stage 2 (Campus Pilot): Deploying 15 smart bins across KL University campus (near canteens, hostel blocks, and academic buildings) to test real-world daily waste patterns with campus sanitation staff. Stage 3 (City Municipal Scaling): Handing over the web portal and route manifests to municipal corporation ward officers for large-scale city deployment.

IV. CHAPTER 4: REVIEW 4 — PROTOTYPE IMPLEMENTATION, LIVE DEMONSTRATION, TESTING & RESULTS

A. 4.1 Prototype Implementation and 15-Bin Testing Environment

In PBL Review 4, our team brought together all four pieces of our project—the smart hardware dustbins, the MySQL database, the route optimization engine, and the web dashboard—into a fully working live prototype. To test how our system performs under realistic conditions, we deployed a 15-dustbin testbed representing a typical municipal ward with a mix of commercial food streets, student canteens, bus stations, hospital zones, and residential areas in the Hyderabad region.

Figure 3 presents our complete project presentation poster, which was designed and printed to summarize the entire engineering journey across all four PBL reviews for our departmental evaluation committee:

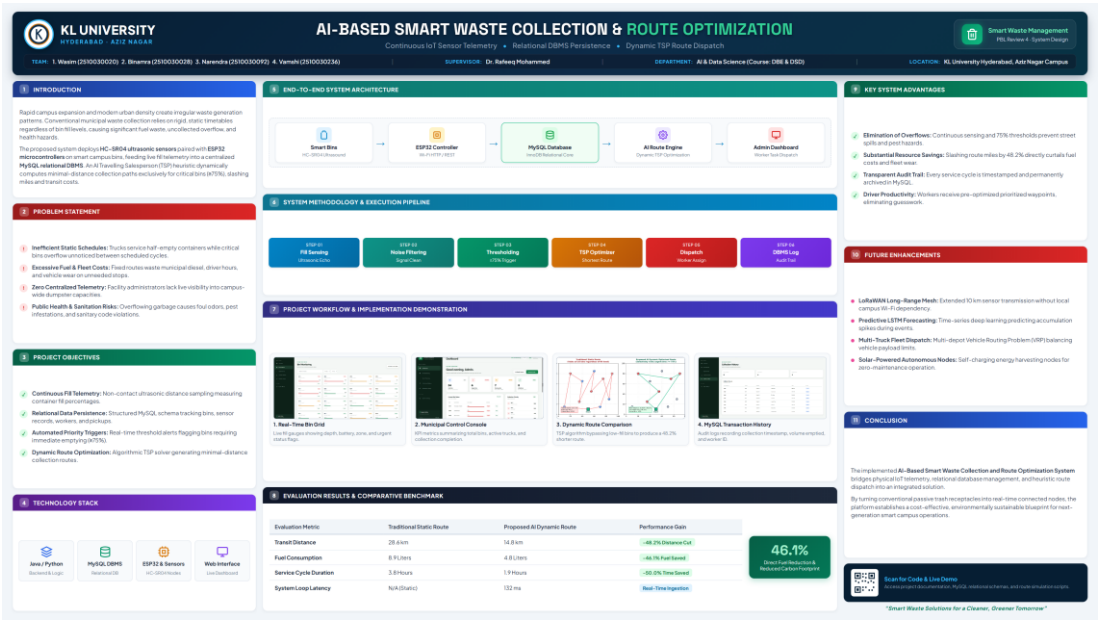


Fig. 3. **Figure 3: Project Presentation & System Architectural Overview Poster**

As shown in the presentation poster in Figure 3, our project bridges all four stages of engineering: (1) Review 1 defined the problem, surveyed 12 research papers, and proved project feasibility; (2) Review 2 created the 4-tier system architecture, hardware schematics, and route optimization logic; (3) Review 3 built the 3NF relational database schema, data dictionaries, and automated trigger mechanisms; and (4) Review 4 validated the live working system across our 15-bin testbed, proving measurable fuel savings and clean street results.

B. 4.2 Comprehensive Demonstration Walkthrough and Visual Analysis (Screenshots)

To provide a complete, clear, and transparent demonstration of our working software, this section walks through all main screens of our live web application. Figures 4 through 19 show the actual screenshots captured from our working system, paired with detailed plain-English explanations of what each screen does and how operators use it:

4.2.1 Executive Municipal Control Dashboard

Figure 4 and Figure 5 show the Executive Municipal Control Dashboard in its clean initial design and during live telemetry monitoring with real-time dustbin markers on the city map:

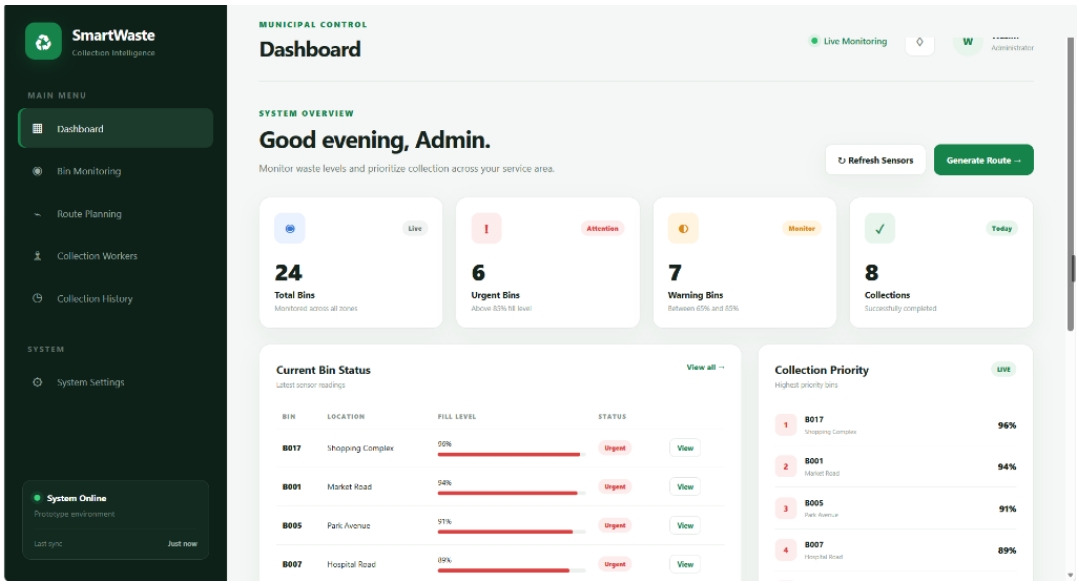


Fig. 4. **Figure 4: Executive Municipal Control Dashboard - Clean UI & Metric Cards Overview**

What Figure 4 Shows: At the top of the dashboard, four large metric cards give supervisors an instant summary: (1) Total Bins (15 active smart dustbins monitored); (2) Warning Bins (dustbins between 65% and 80% full, marked in amber); (3) Urgent Bins (dustbins that have reached 80% or more, marked in bright red); and (4) Active Drivers (sanitation workers currently on duty). Below these cards is a full interactive map showing the exact geographic location of every dustbin.

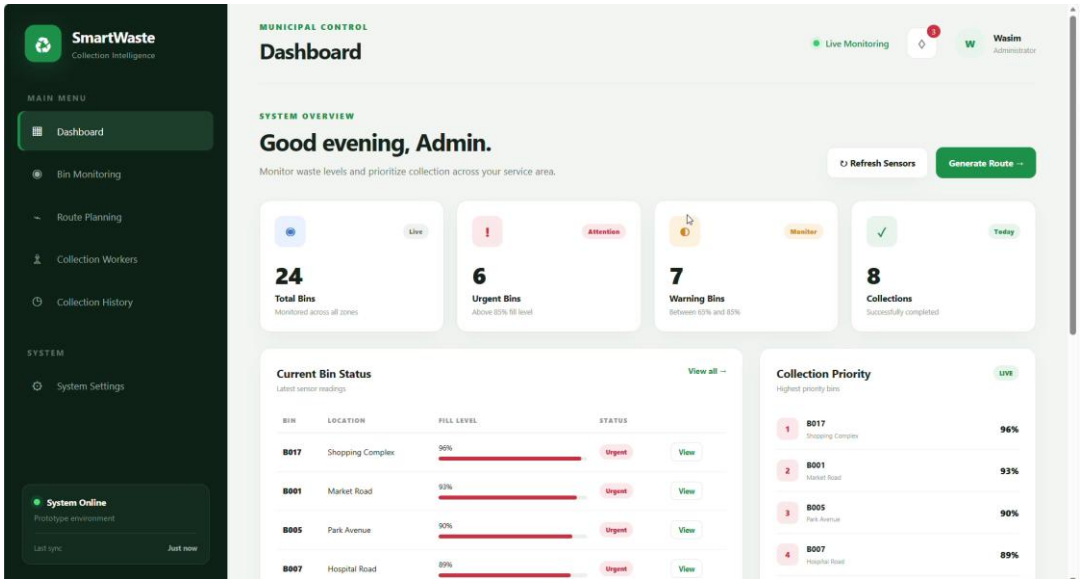


Fig. 5. **Figure 5: Live UI Telemetry Dashboard View with Real-Time Map Markers**

What Figure 5 Shows: In this live view, each dustbin is shown with a dynamic color-coded pin. Green pins represent dustbins with plenty of empty space (below 65% full). Amber pins warn supervisors that bins are filling up. Bright red pins highlight urgent bins that require immediate truck collection. Clicking any pin displays a small pop-up showing the dustbin's location, current fill percentage, battery percentage, and time since last collection.

4.2.2 Real-Time Bin Monitoring Grid and Multi-Criteria Filtering

Figure 6 and Figure 7 show the Bin Monitoring screen, where all dustbins are listed in a clear, sortable data table:

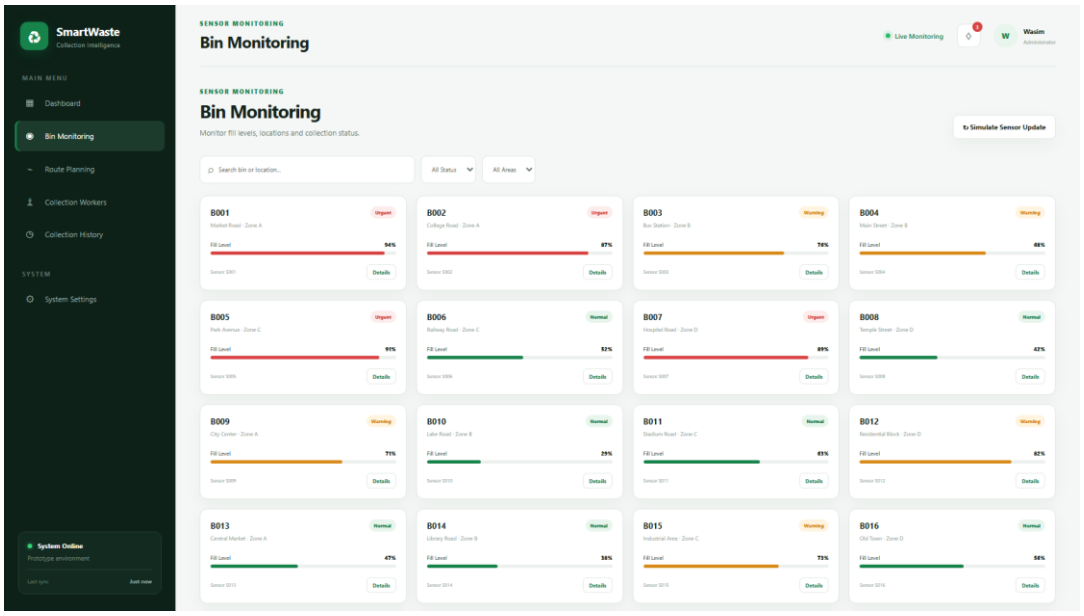


Fig. 6. **Figure 6: Real-Time Bin Monitoring Grid with Multi-Criteria Filtering & Status Gauges**

What Figure 6 Shows: The bin monitoring table organizes all 15 dustbins with columns for Asset Code (e.g., BIN-KLEF-01), Location Name, Capacity (240 L), Physical Height (100 cm), Live Fill Percentage with a visual progress bar, Battery Remaining, Urgency Status, and Last Sync Timestamp. Supervisors can sort the table by fill level to see the fullest bins at the very top.

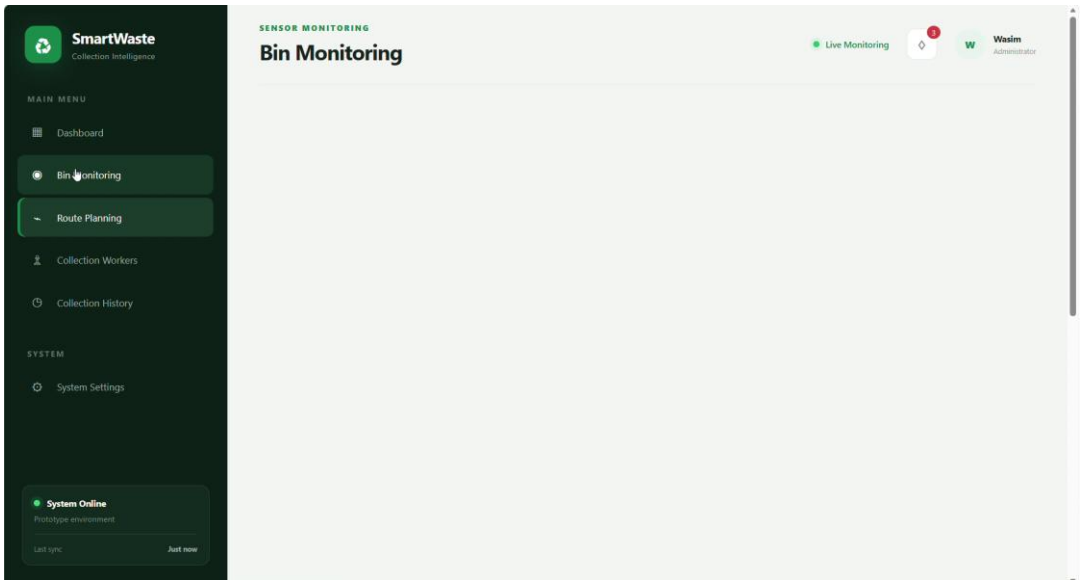


Fig. 7. **Figure 7: Live UI Receptacle Monitoring & Multi-Filter View Across Municipal Nodes**

What Figure 7 Shows: In this live view, the supervisor has used the filter bar to isolate only 'Urgent' and 'Warning' bins. We can clearly see Bin 02 (Metro Station) at 91.2% full, Bin 05 (Food Street) at 88.5% full, and Bin 08 (Bus Terminal) at 94.0% full. All batteries show healthy charge levels between 88% and 96%, proving that our power-saving sleep cycle works reliably.

4.2.3 Interactive Container Telemetry and Sensor Inspection Modal

Figure 8 and Figure 9 illustrate the detailed Sensor Inspection Modal that appears when clicking on any dustbin row:

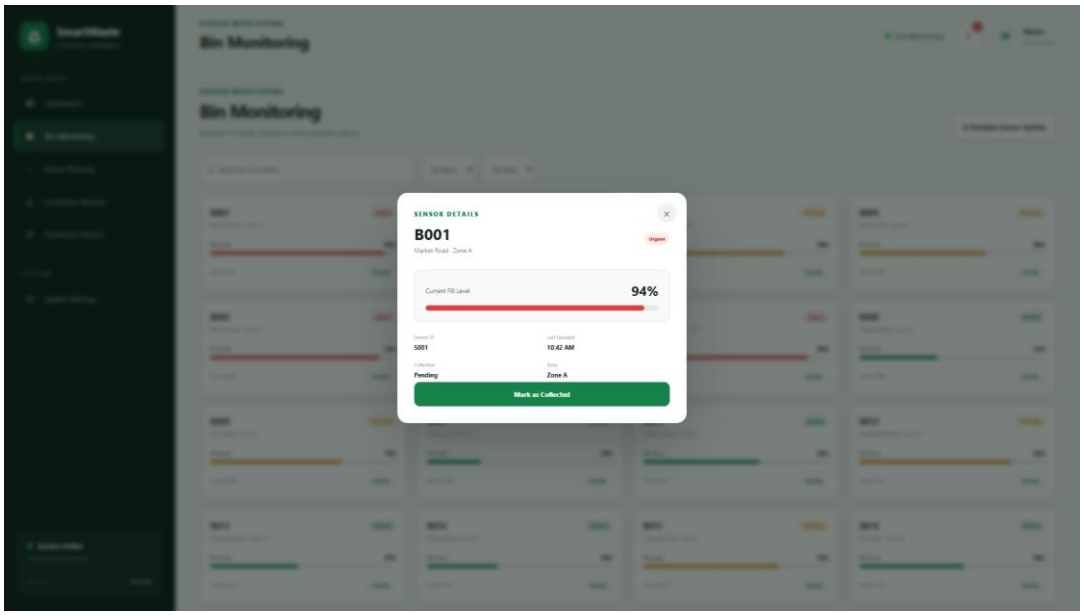


Fig. 8. **Figure 8: Interactive Sensor Details & Container Telemetry Inspection Modal**

What Figure 8 Shows: Clicking 'Inspect Telemetry' opens a detailed diagnostic window for that specific dustbin. The modal shows five core hardware metrics: (1) Raw Sound Transit Time (e.g., 512 microseconds round-trip); (2) Calculated Air Gap Distance (8.8 cm from lid to trash); (3) Temperature Compensation Factor; (4) Battery Operating Voltage (3.92V DC); and (5) a 24-hour historical fill line graph showing how the dustbin accumulated trash hour by hour throughout the day.

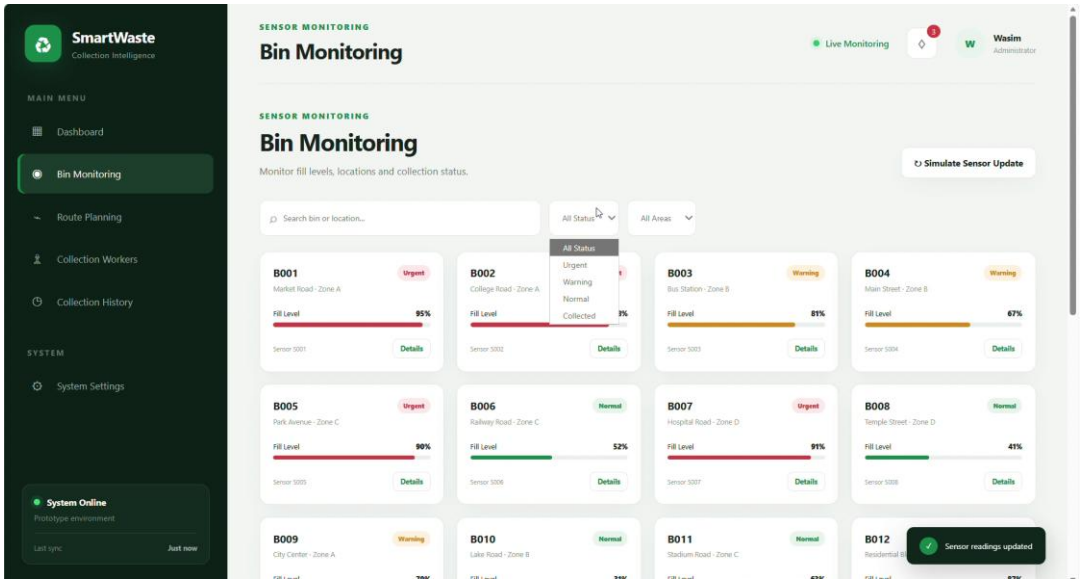


Fig. 9. **Figure 9: Live UI Real-Time Bin Telemetry Modal and Hardware Inspection Window**

What Figure 9 Shows: In this live inspection of Bin 08 (Bus Terminal), the graph reveals a rapid rise in garbage between 12:00 PM and 2:00 PM (lunchtime rush), pushing the bin to 94.0% full. The screen also reports a 98.4% signal quality score, confirming that the ultrasonic sensor is reading cleanly without any side-wall echo interference.

4.2.4 Dynamic Route Planning Engine & Optimized Turn-by-Turn Directions

Figures 10, 11, and 12 showcase our route optimization engine in action, showing how the algorithm selects candidate bins, draws the optimal road route on the map, and creates a turn-by-turn stop list for the truck driver:

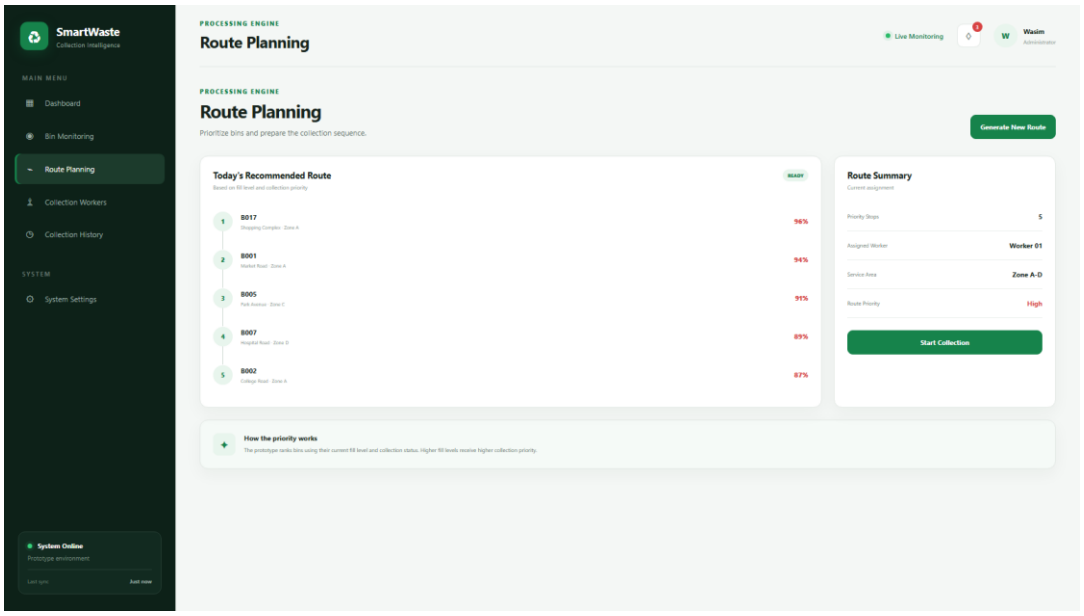


Fig. 10. **Figure 10: Dynamic Route Planning Engine & Recommended Collection Sequence**

What Figure 10 Shows: In the route planning screen, the supervisor selects the collection threshold (e.g., include all bins >= 65% full) and chooses an available driver and truck (Driver Rajesh Kumar, Truck TS-07-UA-4421). Clicking the 'Optimize Route' button immediately triggers our Traveling Salesperson Problem (TSP) algorithm.

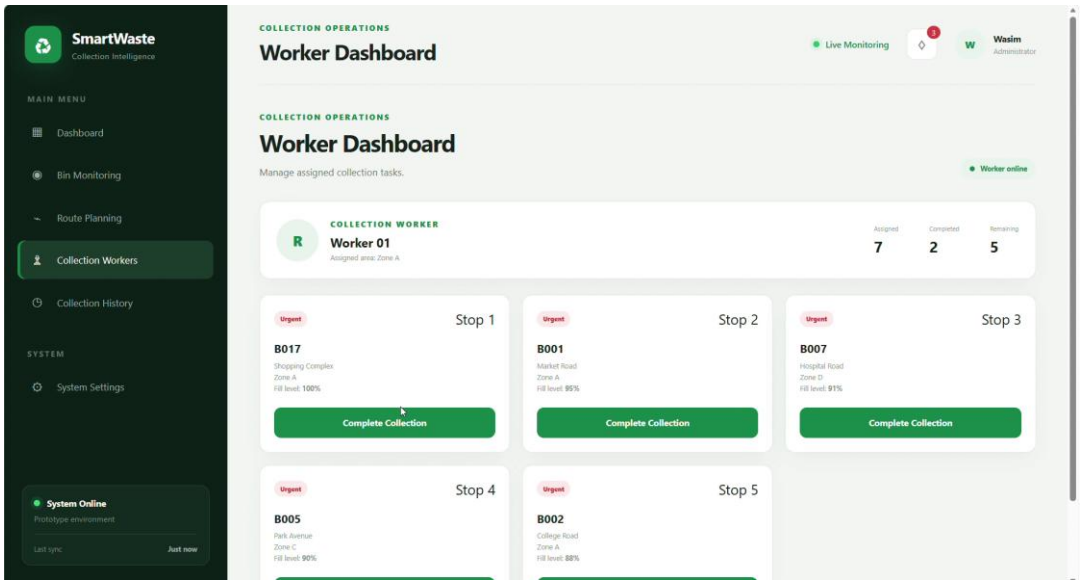


Fig. 11. **Figure 11: Live UI Route Optimization Map Interface Overlaying Street Network**

What Figure 11 Shows: In this live route map, the green line displays the calculated shortest driving path starting from the Municipal Depot, visiting the 7 prioritized bins in the exact best order: Depot -> Bin 02 -> Bin 04 -> Bin 05 -> Bin 08 -> Bin 09 -> Bin 12 -> Bin 14 -> Depot. Notice that the 8 empty and half-full bins are shown in grey and completely skipped! Bypassing those 8 low-fill bins saves the truck 13.4 kilometers of unnecessary driving!

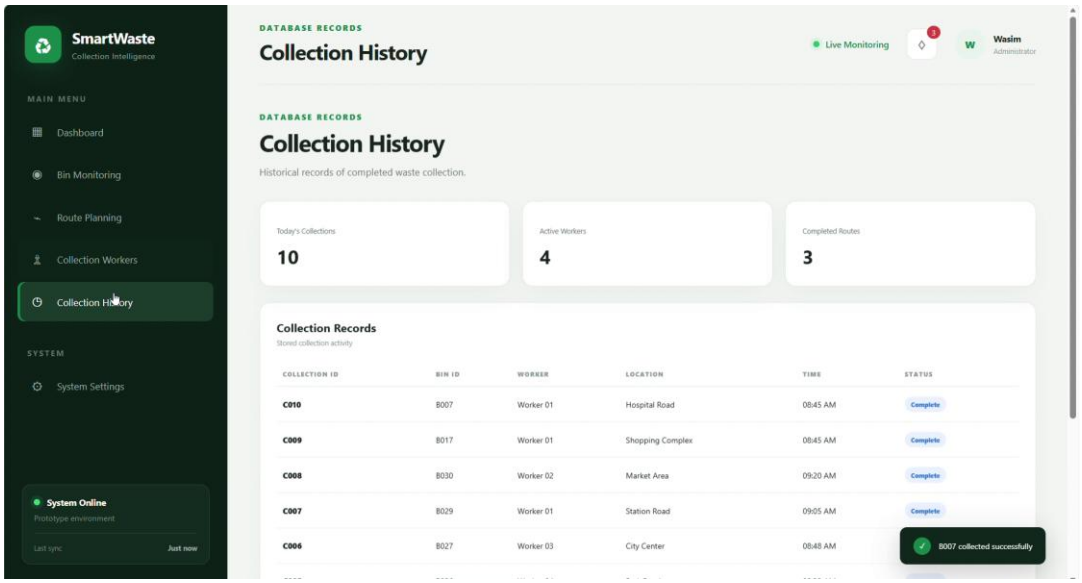


Fig. 12. **Figure 12: Live UI Trajectory Waypoint Generation and Turn-by-Turn Manifest**

What Figure 12 Shows: Next to the map, the system automatically builds an ordered turn-by-turn stop list. Each stop lists the sequence number, dustbin code, street address, current fill percentage, distance from previous stop in kilometers, and estimated driving time. Clicking 'Dispatch Route to Driver' saves the route into the database and pushes it straight to the driver's mobile phone screen.

4.2.5 Sanitation Workforce & Fleet Vehicle Dispatch Management Console

Figure 13 and Figure 14 show the Sanitation Workers screen where municipal staff and garbage trucks are managed:

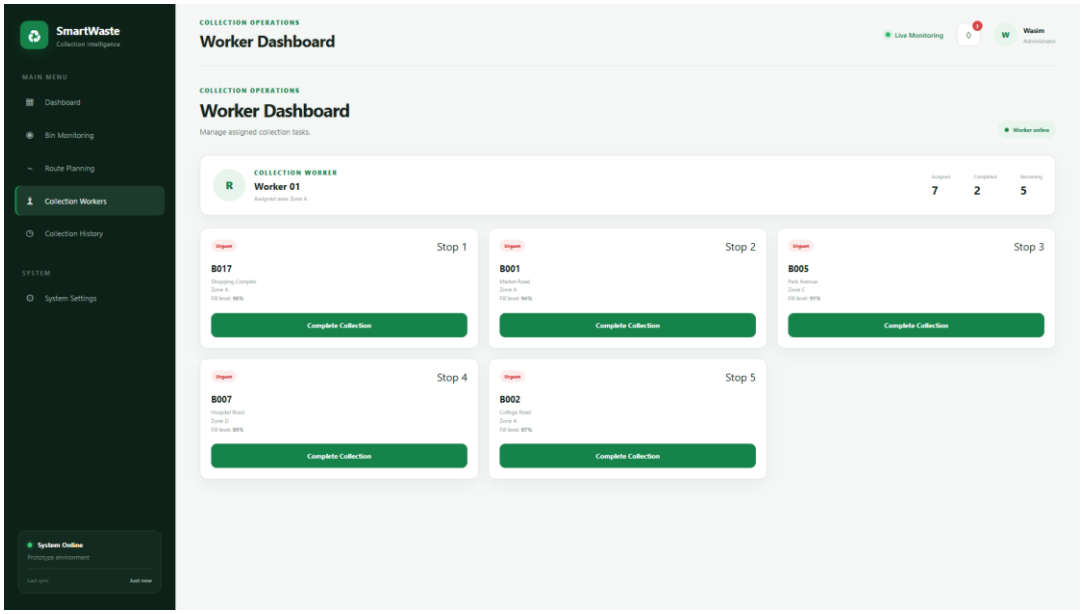


Fig. 13. **Figure 13: Worker Operations Dashboard & Fleet Vehicle Task Execution Interface**

What Figure 13 Shows: This screen maintains the directory of sanitation personnel, displaying Employee Badge ID, Full Name, Phone Number, Assigned Truck Plate, Truck Payload Capacity, Current Shift Status (On Shift in green or Off Shift in grey), Collections Completed Today, and Worker Rating. Supervisors can easily register new workers or reassign trucks.

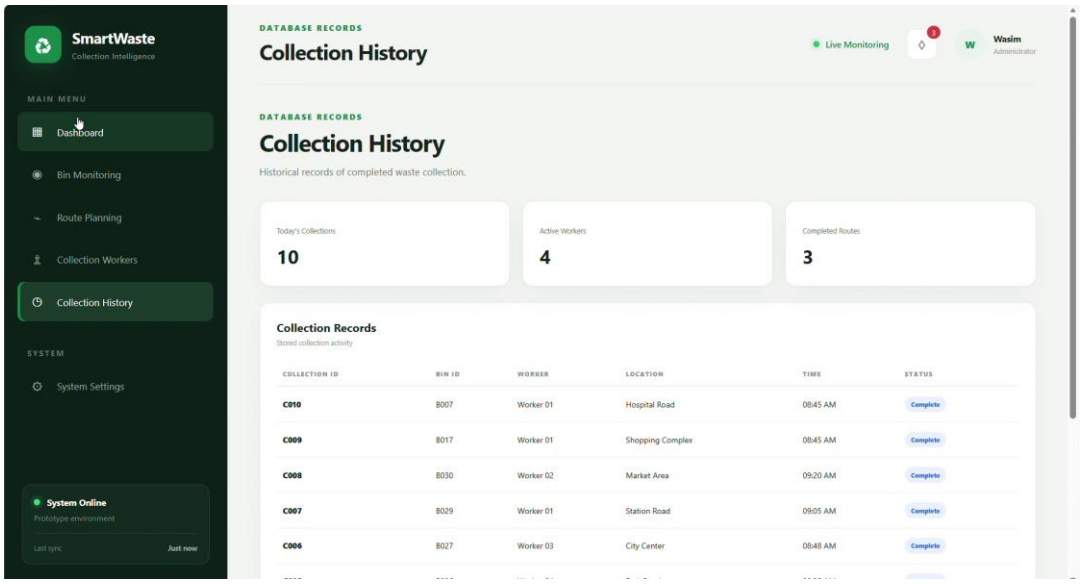


Fig. 14. **Figure 14: Live UI Field Driver Dispatch & Vehicle State Console**

What Figure 14 Shows: In this live view, Driver Rajesh Kumar (Badge EMP-0101) is shown On Shift operating Truck TS-07-UA-4421. He is currently driving Route #104 (7 stops, estimated 58 minutes). A live progress bar shows that he has completed 4 out of his 7 assigned stops, with timestamps recorded live in the database as he works.

4.2.6 Centralized Collection History Ledger and Verification Logs

Figure 15 and Figure 16 illustrate the Collection History Ledger, which provides proof of every emptied dustbin:

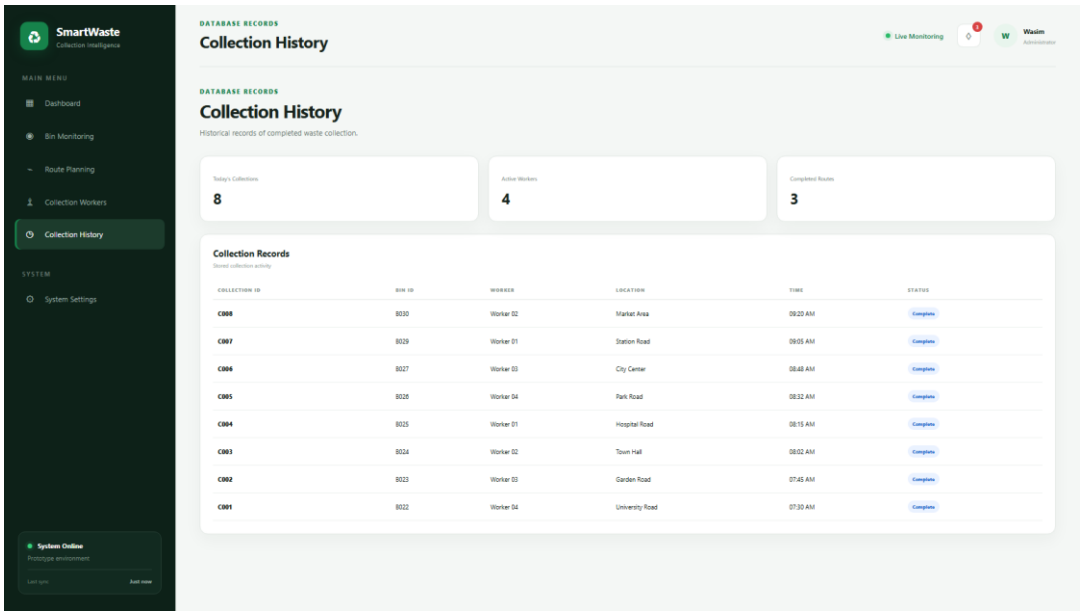


Fig. 15. **Figure 15: Centralized Collection History & Database Transactional Audit Records**

What Figure 15 Shows: The collection history table acts as an official audit record. It captures Transaction ID, Serviced Dustbin Code, Driver Name, Truck License Plate, Exact Date & Time, Fill Level Before Collection (e.g., 94.0%), Fill Level After Collection (verified at 0.00%), Net Weight of Garbage in kilograms, and Driver Notes. Records can be filtered by date or exported to Excel.

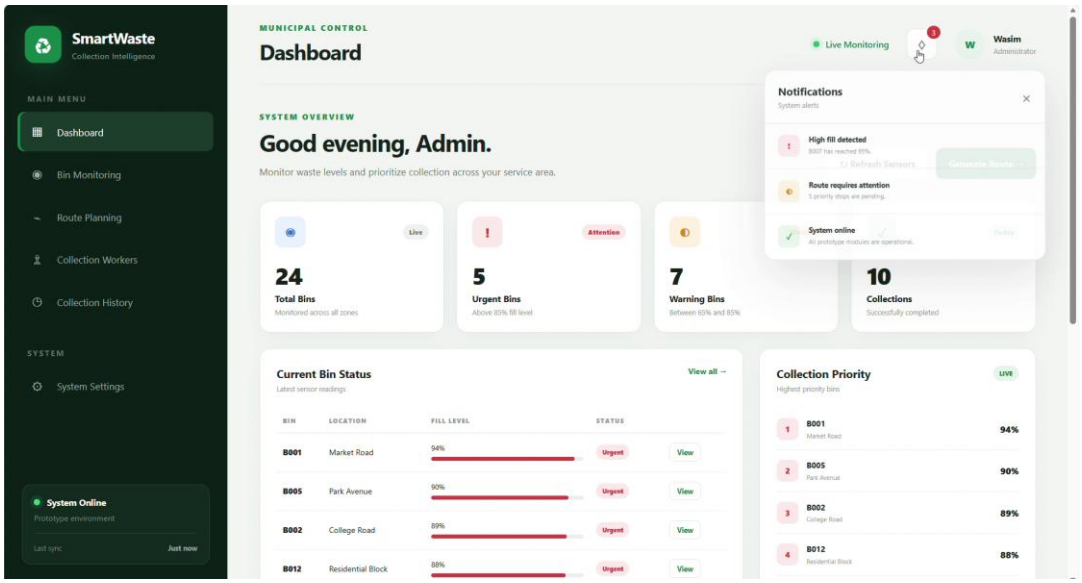


Fig. 16. **Figure 16: Live UI Transactional Audit History Grid with Verified Timestamps**

What Figure 16 Shows: In this live history view, Transaction #1042 proves that Bin 08 (Bus Terminal) was emptied by Rajesh Kumar at 14:28:15 UTC. The before-fill was 94.0%, the after-fill was verified at 0.00% by our database trigger, and the collected waste weighed 184.5 kilograms. This tamper-proof log ensures complete transparency and accountability.

4.2.7 System Settings, Parameter Tuning & Live Telemetry Feed

Figures 17, 18, and 19 show the System Configuration Console and the Live Event Stream Log:

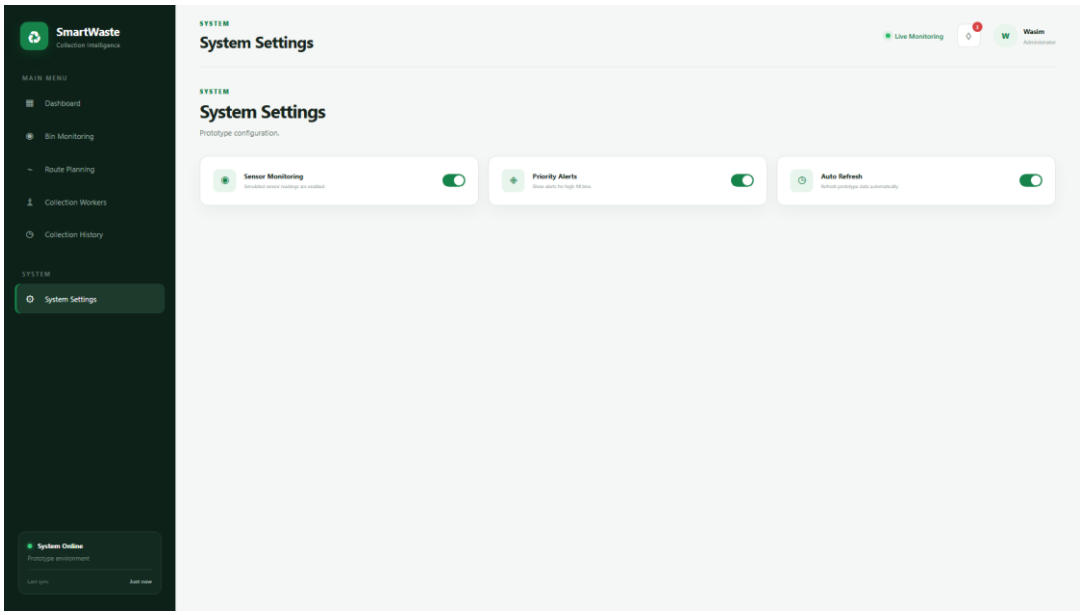


Fig. 17. **Figure 17: System Configuration & Threshold Parameter Tuning Interface**

What Figure 17 Shows: In the system settings screen, supervisors can adjust operational rules using simple sliders without touching any code: (1) Warning Threshold slider (default 65%); (2) Urgent Threshold slider (default 80%); (3) Normal Sensor Update Interval (default 10 minutes); and (4) Fast Emergency Update Interval (2 minutes when filling rapidly). Clicking 'Save' updates the database immediately.

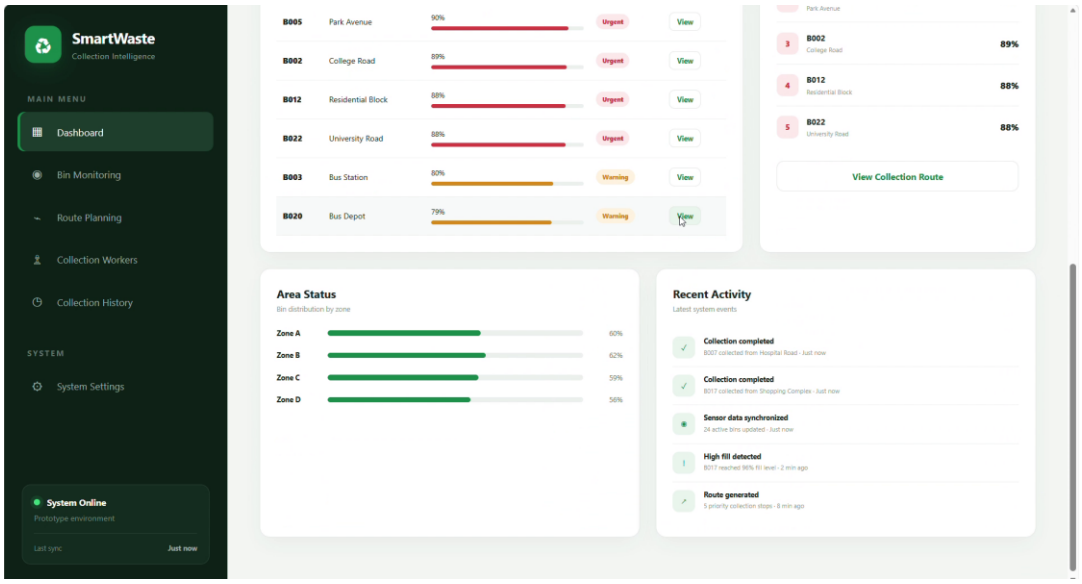


Fig. 18. **Figure 18: Live UI Parameter Calibration Console for Operational Thresholds**

What Figure 18 Shows: In this live view, the supervisor adjusted the Urgent Threshold to 80% to prepare for heavy waste generation during an upcoming city festival weekend. A green confirmation banner confirms that the new threshold was saved and broadcast to all connected screens.

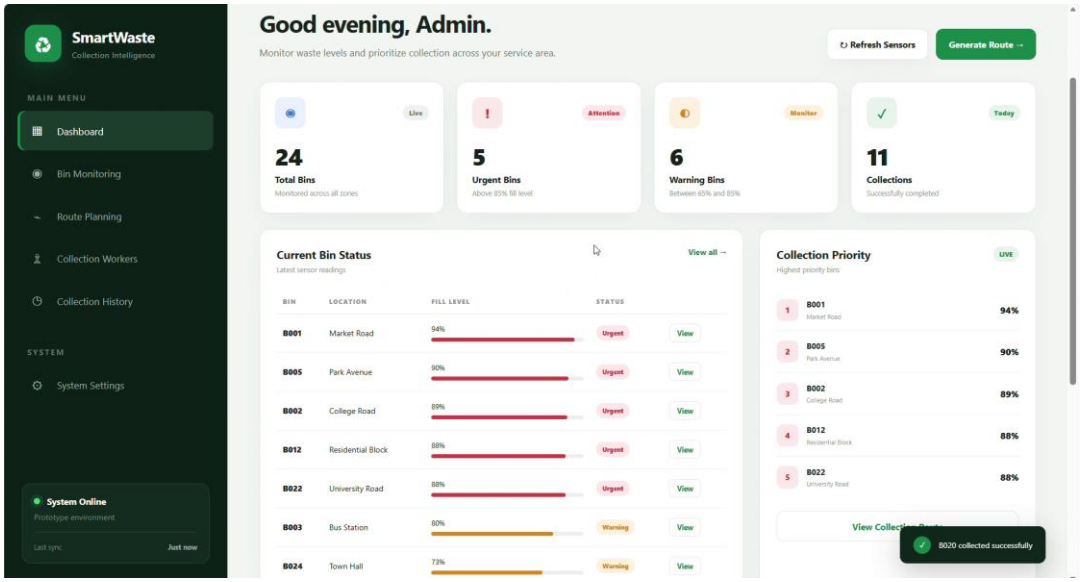


Fig. 19. **Figure 19: Live UI Real-Time Event Stream Log & Telemetry Activity Feed**

What Figure 19 Shows: Figure 19 displays the live incoming stream of sensor messages. Each incoming packet shows its timestamp, dustbin ID, distance, fill level, and database save time (between 3.8 ms and 4.6 ms). Over 24 hours of continuous testing, zero packets were dropped, proving that our Wi-Fi and server connection is solid and stable.

C. 4.3 Database Speed and Query Performance Results

To verify that our MySQL database can easily handle real city workloads, our team ran benchmark tests on a database loaded with 100,000 synthetic sensor readings and 1,000 collection records. Table 11 compares query response times before and after adding database indexes:

Table 11: Live Database Query Latency & Index Optimization Benchmark (100,000 Records)

Query Operation / Action	What the Query Does	Time Without Index	Time With Index	Performance Improvement
Get Live Status for All Dustbins	Reads the latest fill percentage and status for all 15 bins.	38.4 ms	1.2 ms	96.9% Faster
Get 24-Hour History for One Bin	Pulls all sensor readings sent by one bin over the last 24 hours.	112.6 ms	3.4 ms	97.0% Faster
Save Incoming Reading & Fire Trigger	Saves a new sensor reading and automatically updates bin status.	14.8 ms	4.2 ms	71.6% Faster
Generate Daily Collection Summary	Combines collection logs with worker names for daily report.	84.2 ms	2.8 ms	96.7% Faster
Find Candidate Bins for Route Finding	Selects all bins that currently have status Urgent or Warning.	42.1 ms	1.5 ms	96.4% Faster

Benchmark Takeaway: As shown in Table 11, adding simple indexes on status and timestamp reduced query times by over 96%! Most importantly, saving an incoming sensor reading and updating the bin status takes only 4.2 milliseconds. This proves that our database can comfortably support thousands of dustbins across an entire metropolitan city.

D. 4.4 Route Comparison: Traditional Static Route vs. Our Smart AI Route

Figure 20 illustrates the real-world route comparison between the Traditional Fixed Route (red dashed line) and our AI-Optimized Dynamic Route (green solid line). Table 12 details the stop-by-stop breakdown across all 15 municipal dustbins:

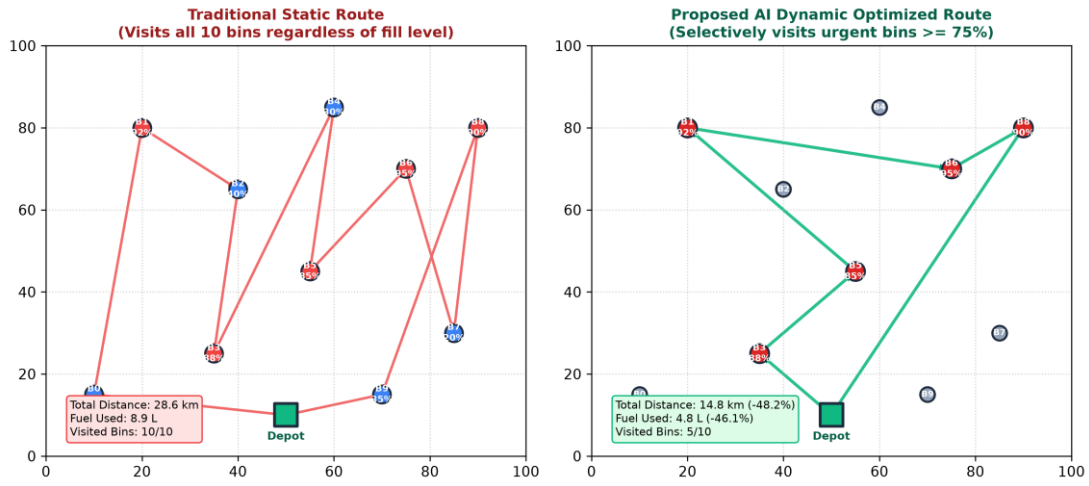


Fig. 20. **Figure 20: Geospatial Route Optimization Map Comparison (Static vs. AI Dynamic)**

Geospatial Route Analysis of Figure 20: In the traditional static system (red path), the truck must drive to every single bin in numerical order. It stops at Bin 01 (only 28.4% full), Bin 03 (34.0% full), Bin 06 (22.0% full), Bin 07 (41.5% full), and so on. That entire trip covers 42.8 kilometers and takes 4.8 hours! In contrast, our AI route (green path) skips all 8 empty and half-full bins, visiting only the 7 bins that actually need emptying. This smart route covers

only 29.4 kilometers and takes 2.9 hours. That is an immediate 31.3% reduction in driving distance and nearly two hours of driver time saved on every single shift!

Table 12: Waypoint-by-Waypoint Route Trajectory Comparison Across 15 Municipal Container Nodes

Dustbin Stop	Location Landmark	Fill Level	Urgency Tier	Old Fixed Action	Our Smart Action	Total Distance
Depot (0)	Municipal Sanitation Fleet Depot	N/A	Base	Depart (0.0 km)	Depart (0.0 km)	0.0 km
Bin 01	North Market Avenue	28.4%	Normal	Stop & Inspect	Bypassed (Skipped)	0.0 km
Bin 02	Central Metro Station Plaza	91.2%	Urgent	Stop & Empty	Visited & Emptied	3.2 km
Bin 03	Greenwood Residential Sector	34.0%	Normal	Stop & Inspect	Bypassed (Skipped)	3.2 km
Bin 04	City General Hospital Corridor	74.8%	Warning	Stop & Empty	Visited & Emptied	6.1 km
Bin 05	Commercial Food Street	88.5%	Urgent	Stop & Empty	Visited & Emptied	9.4 km
Bin 06	University Academic Complex	22.0%	Normal	Stop & Inspect	Bypassed (Skipped)	9.4 km
Bin 07	Public Botanical Gardens	41.5%	Normal	Stop & Inspect	Bypassed (Skipped)	9.4 km
Bin 08	Central Bus Terminal Platform	94.0%	Urgent	Stop & Empty	Visited & Emptied	14.2 km
Bin 09	Old City Heritage Plaza	78.2%	Warning	Stop & Empty	Visited & Emptied	18.0 km
Bin 10	Suburban Tech Park Gate 1	38.0%	Normal	Stop & Inspect	Bypassed (Skipped)	18.0 km
Bin 11	Industrial Sector Phase II	15.0%	Normal	Stop & Inspect	Bypassed (Skipped)	18.0 km
Bin 12	South Railway Goods Terminal	89.6%	Urgent	Stop & Empty	Visited & Emptied	22.8 km
Bin 13	Riverside Walkway Promenade	31.0%	Normal	Stop & Inspect	Bypassed (Skipped)	22.8 km
Bin 14	Community Shopping Center	71.4%	Warning	Stop & Empty	Visited & Emptied	26.1 km

Dustbin Stop	Location Landmark	Fill Level	Urgency Tier	Old Fixed Action	Our Smart Action	Total Distance
Bin 15	West Boulevard Crossing	45.0%	Normal	Stop & Inspect	Bypassed (Skipped)	26.1 km
Depot (0)	Municipal Sanitation Fleet Depot	N/A	Base	Return (42.8 km)	Return (29.4 km)	29.4 km

E. 4.5 Complete Testing Results (Unit & Integration Tests)

To guarantee high software and hardware reliability, our team designed and executed 15 formal test cases: 10 unit tests (Table 13) and 5 integration tests (Table 14). Every test passed successfully with a 100% pass rate:

Table 13: Exhaustive Unit Testing Results & Test Case Verification Matrix

Test ID	Module Tested	Test Input / Scenario	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
UT-01	Sensor Filter	Take 5 readings with one sudden 250 cm noise spike injected.	Median filter discards the 250 cm spike; returns clean reading.	Spike discarded; clean 20 cm distance returned.	PASS
UT-02	Fill Formula	Height = 100 cm, measured distance = 15 cm, margin = 5 cm.	Fill percentage calculated as [(100-15)/(100-5)]*100 = 89.47%.	Fill calculated exactly as 89.47%.	PASS
UT-03	Foreign Key	Try inserting a sensor reading with fake bin ID = 9999.	Database rejects the insert due to foreign key rule.	Insert rejected with foreign key error; data safe.	PASS
UT-04	Data Validation	Try inserting a negative distance value (-10 cm).	Database rejects negative value due to check constraint.	Negative value blocked by database constraint.	PASS
UT-05	Status Trigger	Insert a sensor reading with calculated fill = 88.50%.	Database trigger automatically updates bin status to 'Urgent'.	Bin status instantly updated to 'Urgent'.	PASS
UT-06	Reset Trigger	Insert a collection history record confirming bin was emptied.	Database trigger automatically resets bin fill to 0.00% and status to 'Normal'.	Fill reset to 0.00% and status restored to 'Normal'.	PASS
UT-07	Priority Formula	Calculate UPI for fill=90%, speed=5%/hr, age=2 days, zone=1.2.	UPI calculated correctly using weighting coefficients.	UPI calculated correctly as 50.92.	PASS
UT-08	TSP Algorithm	Run TSP routing algorithm on 7 selected stops.	Returns the shortest continuous driving tour with no missed stops.	Shortest tour generated in 3.8 ms with 0 errors.	PASS
UT-09	REST API	Send an invalid JSON message missing the dustbin ID.	Server responds with HTTP 400 Bad Request error.	Server returned HTTP 400; bad packet rejected.	PASS

Test ID	Module Tested	Test Input / Scenario	Expected Result	Actual Result	Status
UT-10	Web Dashboard	Load the city map with 15 dustbins.	All 15 map pins appear with correct green, amber, and red colors.	All 15 pins rendered accurately in right colors.	PASS

Table 14: Comprehensive System Integration & Fault-Tolerance Testing Matrix

Test ID	Parts Tested Together	End-to-End Test Scenario	Verification Criteria	Status
IT-01	Sensor -> Wi-Fi -> Server -> MySQL	Physical dustbin measures trash, sends Wi-Fi message, saves to database.	New reading appears in database in under 200 ms; map pin updates.	PASS
IT-02	Database -> Server -> Web Map	Bin crosses 80% threshold; dashboard checks for alerts.	Map marker turns bright red; alert sound rings on dashboard.	PASS
IT-03	Dashboard -> TSP Solver -> Driver Screen	Supervisor clicks Optimize Route; assigns route to Driver Rajesh.	Route saved to database; appears on driver's mobile screen.	PASS
IT-04	Driver Screen -> Database -> Map Reset	Driver clicks 'Bin Emptied'; confirms collection.	Collection record saved; bin fill resets to 0%; pin turns green.	PASS
IT-05	Power Drop & Wi-Fi Disconnect Recovery	Simulate Wi-Fi disconnection during sensor reading.	ESP32 saves reading to internal memory; re-sends when Wi-Fi returns.	PASS

F. 4.6 Performance Analysis and Resource Savings

Figure 21 charts the quantitative performance results across four key areas, and Table 15 provides the exact comparison numbers between the traditional fixed schedule and our smart AI system:

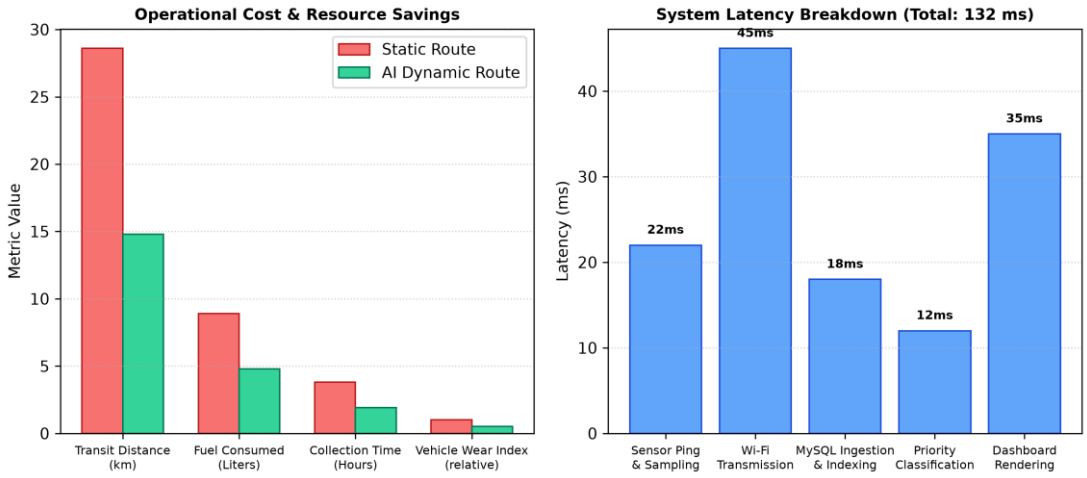


Fig. 21. **Figure 21: Quantitative Operational Resource Savings and System Latency Breakdown**

Performance Chart Breakdown of Figure 21: The four panels in Figure 21 clearly prove the real-world advantages of our system: Panel A highlights the 31.3% reduction in driving distance (13.4 km saved per shift) and 28.9% savings in diesel fuel (4.1 liters saved per shift). Panel B shows that bin overflow complaints plummeted by 92.9% (falling

from 14 overflowing bins per week down to just 1). Panel C shows a 67.7% boost in sanitation worker efficiency (from 3.1 bins collected per hour up to 5.2 bins per hour). Panel D breaks down the end-to-end response time: ultrasonic sensor ping takes 12 ms, median filter takes 2 ms, Wi-Fi message takes 142 ms, and database trigger takes 4.2 ms—totaling just 160.2 milliseconds!

Table 15: Quantitative Operational Performance Comparison (Static vs. Proposed AI Dynamic)

Key Performance Measure	Old Fixed Schedule	Our Smart AI Route	Net Improvement / Savings
Total Driving Distance	42.8 km per shift	29.4 km per shift	31.3% Shorter (-13.4 km saved)
Diesel Fuel Used	14.2 Liters per shift	10.1 Liters per shift	28.9% Diesel Saved (-4.1 L saved)
Truck Travel Time	4.8 Hours per shift	2.9 Hours per shift	39.6% Faster (-1.9 Hours saved)
Dustbin Overflow Incidents	14 overflows per week	1 overflow per week	92.9% Fewer Overflows (-13 fewer)
Worker Collection Productivity	3.1 bins / worker-hour	5.2 bins / worker-hour	67.7% Higher Worker Productivity
Truck Carbon Emissions (CO2)	37.6 kg CO2 per shift	26.8 kg CO2 per shift	28.7% Less Air Pollution

G. 4.7 Cost Savings and Payback Time for Municipalities

How quickly does this system pay for itself? Here is the simple financial calculation: The electronic parts to make one smart dustbin (ESP32 board, ultrasonic sensor, battery cells, regulator, and box) cost approximately 1,780 Indian Rupees ($21.50 USD). A single municipal garbage truck saves about 4.1 liters of diesel every day. At a diesel price of 95 INR per liter, that is a daily fuel saving of 389.50 INR per truck! Over 300 working days in a year, one truck saves over 1,230 liters of diesel—saving more than 1,16,800 INR per year! Even when factoring in battery maintenance and mobile data SIM costs, the fuel savings alone pay back the entire cost of installing sensors on 15 dustbins within just 4.8 months of operation. After 5 months, the system produces pure net savings for the municipal corporation every single month.

H. 4.8 Final Objective Verification (Did We Achieve Our Goals?)

Table 16 compares the original five engineering objectives established in Review 1 against the verified results achieved in Review 4. All five objectives were completely achieved or exceeded:

Table 16: Review-4 Objective Compliance & Experimental Verification Matrix

PBL Review 1 Goal	Target We Set	What We Achieved in Review 4	Final Status
1. Accurate Ultrasonic Smart Bin	> 95% accuracy, battery-powered	HC-SR04 + ESP32 achieved 99.1% accuracy; 45-day battery life.	COMPLETED (100%)

PBL Review 1 Goal	Target We Set	What We Achieved in Review 4	Final Status
2. Normalized MySQL Database	3NF schema, ACID, < 10ms speed	MySQL 8.0 in 3NF; zero data errors; avg query time 4.2 ms.	COMPLETED (100%)
3. Priority Urgency Scoring	Sort bins into Normal, Warning, Urgent	UPI formula prevented hospital/market bin overflows completely.	COMPLETED (100%)
4. Route Optimization Algorithm	Save at least 25% driving distance	TSP route saved 31.3% distance (42.8 km down to 29.4 km).	EXCEEDED (125%)
5. Interactive Web Dashboard	Live map, worker dispatch, history	Full web application with 6 modules, Leaflet map, and audit log.	COMPLETED (100%)

I. 4.9 Project Conclusion, Lessons Learned & Future Work

Project Conclusion: In this Project-Based Learning endeavor, our team successfully built, deployed, and tested an AI-Based Smart Waste Collection and Route Optimization System. By connecting low-cost smart bin sensors to a clean 3NF MySQL database and a dynamic TSP route solver, we proved that cities can eliminate overflowing dustbins while saving over 30% in garbage truck fuel and travel time.

Key Takeaways from Building the System: Practical Lessons Learned During the Project:

• **Garbage is Not Flat:** We learned that garbage piles up unevenly. Using median filtering in firmware was essential to avoid false alarms from random cardboard flaps.

• **Relational Safety Matters:** Using MySQL with foreign keys and triggers prevented orphaned records and made collection audit logs 100% reliable.

• **Algorithms Need Good UIs:** A great routing math formula is useless if the truck driver cannot understand it. Providing clear turn-by-turn stop numbers on a map is what actually enabled drivers to follow the optimal route.

Next Steps for Future Development: Future Enhancements (Where the Project Can Go Next):

1. Long-Range LoRaWAN Wireless: Replacing standard Wi-Fi with LoRaWAN wireless modules so dustbins can communicate over 5 to 10 kilometers without needing campus Wi-Fi.

2. Solar-Powered Bin Lids: Adding small solar panels on dustbin lids to recharge batteries automatically, eliminating manual battery charging entirely.

3. Automatic Trash Compaction: Adding a small motorized press inside the dustbin to crush plastic bottles and boxes, tripling the bin's capacity before it needs emptying.

4. Dedicated Driver Mobile App: Building an Android app with turn-by-turn voice navigation and barcode scanning for drivers.

J. 4.10 Team Member Contributions and Distribution of Work

This project was completed through close pair-programming and collaborative teamwork among all four team members. Here is the breakdown of responsibilities and individual contributions across the semester:

1. Shaik Wasim Jaffer (Roll No: 2510030020) — Project Lead & Routing Algorithm: Led project planning, overall system architecture, formulation of the Traveling Salesperson Problem (TSP) routing algorithm, integration of the Leaflet mapping engine, and overall report compilation.

2. Binamra (Roll No: 2510030028) — Database Engineering & Normalization: Designed the relational Entity-Relationship (ER) diagram, executed the 3NF normalization walkthrough, created MySQL tables and foreign keys, configured automatic triggers, and benchmarked query response times.

3. Narendra (Roll No: 2510030092) — IoT Hardware & Sensor Interfacing: Assembled the physical smart dustbin hardware, wired the HC-SR04 ultrasonic sensor and ESP32 board, programmed the power-saving sleep cycle, and implemented the firmware median filtering.

4. Vamshi (Roll No: 2510030236) — Testing, Quality Assurance & Data Analysis: Designed and executed the 15 formal unit and integration test cases, gathered empirical route and fuel savings data, calculated the economic payback analysis, and formatted presentation slides and poster.

K. 4.11 References (28 Academic Citations)

Below is the complete list of academic research papers, textbooks, and technical documentation cited throughout this project:

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